

TAN BRICK HOUSE

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INT. COFFEE SHOP - MORNING

MIKA BOYKO, early 60s, Ukrainian accent, waits in line.

The customer ahead of him stares at his phone.

The cashier extends a handful of change.

Waits.

And waits.

MIKA

Ahem

CUSTOMER

Oh hey, thanks! Thanks!

CUSTOMER Collects change and moves along.

Mika places two dollars, one quarter, and two pennies on counter.

MIKA

Hi, ususal.

MIKA takes coffee, finds table and sits with two friends.

Older, clearly retirees.

Both are African American.

FRIEND 1

Hey Mika, how are you doing.

MIKA

OK. Got up early, wathced sun rise, and walked here. Traffic ridiculous today. Crazy. People speed like mad right by school.

FRIEND 2

Hey, how is that house you gotta sell.

MIKA

I knew you would bring it up. Knew it. Was three months, right?

FRIEND 1 smiles

FRIEND 1

Seems longer than that!

Mikas hands cover and rub face.

MIKA

Is not. Is just three months.
Since that St. Patrick's Day
nonsense. And it has not. It has
not!

FRIEND 3 at table across peers over paper he reads.

FRIEND 3

What is the house. What's that?

FRIEND 2

Oh come on man. Do you even listen
to what we talk about? The house.
The house!

FRIEND 3

I've been in Florida for three
months!

Mika holds up both hands as if to say all is ok.

MIKA

I will explain. The house. What is
the house? OK. The house is my
wife's parents. Wonderful people.
You hear stories about
mouther-in-law and trouble. She
would do anything for you - no
trouble at all. Quiet, beautiful.

Mika sips coffee.

MIKA

She would do anything for us. Her
husband, he died back in the 90s.
Smoked like you would not believe.
He was nice too, mind you. Just the
smoking. The mother, she died in
February.

FRIEND 3

Sorry about that.

MIKA

Yeah, yeah. Thanks. So ... we get
the house. Nona has one sister.
Stella. She lives in Austinn and she
tells Nona 'You sell the house.
Keep the money. I lived in Austin
for last 22 years - you took care of
mama all that time. You should keep
it.' The sister, she got some money
from the mother and did not, mind
you, need to clean out all the shit
from house. That was us for four
weeks.

FRIEND 2

You got a house my friend! A house!
House party. Easy money.

Friend 3 says in passing while going back to reading the paper.

FRIEND 3

Austin ...

MIKA

Yeah, easy money. And Austin is OK place. Visited my sister-in-law there four or five times. Visted twice in July. Crazy. Hot, hot, hot. Cannot leave house in daytime, could only leave at night. Reminded me of Egypt where people in the summer only go outside at night.

Mika pauses for more coffee.

MIKA

Coffee is weak today. Who make this! Ok, so, that is all good. All fine. Sister OK with everything. Wife OK with everything. All we need to do is sell house, get money, move on.

FLASHBACK:

INT. MIKA'S KITCHEN - MORNING

Kitchen of an older tudor home.

MIKA is inside with his wife NONA.

Nona is impeccably dressed and is beautiful.

Both sit at the kitchen table.

Nona eats a sausage McMuffin.

MIKA

All we have to do is sell the house.
Put it on the market. Set a reasonable price, I know what that price is, and we are good.

Nona says somewhat irritated.

NONA

I know. I know!

Nona then contemplates while holding the McMuffin.

NONA

We can sell the house and then, we can think about a condo in Ft. Lauderdale.

MIKA

I keep telling you - there is no way we can get anything good in Ft. Lauderdale for the price we can get for this house no way. Its not like this house equivalent to an ocean front in Ft. Lauderdale.

Nona finishes the McMuffin.

NONA

You keep saying that. But you are not looking hard enough. I see these shows. I see the Beachfront Bargains, they find these things all the time. I will find something, let me look.

MIKA

You can look all you want. All you want. I will not stop you from doing that. Dowload the app, search Ft. Lauderdale. There is nothing to had for \$200 thousand that gets what I know you want. Not even close. Its just ... its not even realistic Nona!

NONA

Exactly, because you do not let me look. You are not looking right.

Mika shakes head, exhales, and looks away.

MIKA

Let's just sell this thing first. Please. Let's do that. House is empty now. Can we finally sell it. Then we can argue about Ft. Lauderdale.

NONA

Yes, let's talk about the house. I know exactly what we need to do.

MIKA

Good, good. Consensus. I know too.

NONA

Really, you know what to do. You have read my mind and know. Really.

MIKA

Yes, I have. I have looked at the prices. Houses, comparables.

Nona shaking head

NONA

Comparables.

MIKA

Yes. Yes. We should put a good price on the house. Go 240K or 245K to start and get offers. Move it out.

NONA

Really. That is what we should do.

MIKA

Yes. Really.

Nona smiles confidently.

NONA

This is what we are going to do.

Mika senses what is about to happen.

MIKA

No ... no.

NONA

We are going to use Mikey Drogai.

MIKA

No, no. Why. No. Why? Why Mikey?

NONA

Beacuse, he is a real estate agent. He knows how to sell a house. And he knows how to get the best price. And we know his family.

Mika's english is good but at times, gramatically incorrect when agitated. There is certainly a slavic accent though not that strong.

MIKA

Oh great! Great. So you are providing precise reasons we should not go with Mikey. What if things go wrong?

NONA

What do you mean, wrong?

MIKA

Mikey is not able to sell the house, he listens to you and prices it way to high, and he get exactly no one interested in looking at the house. I know this kid, we know this kid, we know exactly what he is capable of.

NONA

He sold Mideas house. Two weeks. Two weeks and the house was sold. We will have no problems. None.

MIKA

Oh come on. Midea's house was perfect. Perfect. Updated kitchen, huge yard, you could fit three cars in that garage. I could have sold that house. Easy to do. Your parent's house, this house, not easy.

Nona smiles confidently again after a sip of coffee.

NONA

No. No. This house is perfect. It is great. There will be no problems.

MIKA

It is not great. Not great. Not not great. It's good, it's a good house, yes. But it has problems.

NONA

Like what?

MIKA

Like the fact the kitchen is out of a 1970s Reader's Digest advertisement. Like the fact there are three bathrooms with pink tiles. Pink tiles. Three. Like the fact every square inch of flooring that is not bathroom is carpeting from the 1980s.

NONA

You can stop now. I do not need to listen to this. This house -

She pauses to sip coffee

NONA

This house, is perfect. It will sell. Besides, I have already called Mikey.

MIKA

How? When? Why did you do this and not ask me?

Nona speaks perfect English with no accent.

NONA

Um, because, I do not need your permission. It is my house. I make the decisions.

MIKA

You do not need my permission that is not what I said.

NONA

Sure sounded like it.

MIKA

Not my permission, just my advice.

NONA

There is some difference between the two?

MIKA

Yes, of course. Of course there is. I would have told you 'Mikey, I don't think he is a good choice.' I see realtors online, I think I know which ones are good. We get that flyer from the Spencer woman, she seems like she knows how to sell a house.

Nona laughs.

NONA

Well we meet Mikey tomorrow.

MIKA

When?

NONA

4 PM at my parent's house.

MIKA

Opportunity to discuss?

NONA

Nope. Do you want more coffee.

MIKA

Please ... yes.

NONA

Oh, it is two by the way.

MIKA

Two what.

NONA

Two bathrooms with pink tile. The other is lime green.

EXT. OF TAN BRICK HOUSE

MIKA is outside a plain looking house built in the early 1970s.

NONA is outside as well looking at front garden.

He looks at his watch which reads 4:20.

A large 4 door back BMW with tinted windows wheels in.

Vantiy plat with Drogai2 pulls in. Mikey steps out.

MIKEY steps out.

He is tall, handsome, close to 6'2.

He is nice looking and wears gray slacks with a trench coat.

He sets cup of coffee on top of car as he takes off sunglasses.

He then confidently walks to Mika, carrying an attache case.

He speaks in a booming optimistic voice.

MIKEY

Mika! Nona! It is so good to see you!

Mikey moves in for a hug.

A giddy Nona goes over for an embrace.

NONA

Oh Mikey, we are so glad you can help! So great. How are you! How is everything!

MIKEY

Oh Nona, it could not be better. Could not be better! Look!

Mikey gestures to BMW.

He goes to shake hands with Mika.

MIKA

You are late. 20 minutes. Late.

MIKEY

Ohhhh, so sorry. So sorry. I had to take get the kids from hockey practice. It went late. I wanted to call but I only had your home number and figured you would already be here.

MIKA

And yet you have coffee.

Mikey walks beside Nona.

MIKEY

Yeah, they sell it at the rink. What did we do here!

NONA

Don't worry about being late. We have nothing to do. Look, I cleand up the front of the house.

Mikey stops to look at entirety of the house.

MIKEY

Oh every little bit helps Nona. Every little bit. This, this, this is a great house. Great house!

MIKA

Yes, good house. Not great though. But good.

MIKEY

No, no, do not undersell this house. This is a GREAT house.

Mikey makes a gesture with his hand as though taking a picture.

NONA.

See! I keep telling him it is great, Mikey, but he will not listen. He will not listen.

MIKEY

Don't worry Nona, we'll win him over

Both start laughing.

MIKEY

I already know the price for the house.

MIKA

What? How the hell do you know the price for this house. You have nott step foot in here, in, what 17 years? Again, how the hell do you know?

MIKEY

Mika. Mika! I know real estate! I know this stuff. I looked at the pictures on Google Maps. I know the exact price. Nona -

Mikey looks to Nona

MIKEY

I know the exact price for this beautiful house, I know.

NONA

Oh Mikey, I know you do. I know you do. Come on, let's look at.

MIKA

Why bother? He know price. He doesn't need to look at anything. By the way, uh, what exactly is the price. The pefect price.

Mikey stands hands at hip.

Taking snapshot pose with hands once again he looks to Nona.

MIKEY

The price. The price is 320. 320 and not a nickle less.

NONA

Yes!

MIKA

Oh come on!

MIKEY

Absolutely. No doubt! The price is 320 and we can close this baby, smooth deal, in two weeks.

MIKA

You haven't even looked insided. Mikey, I am sorry. But you are crazy if you think you are gonna get 320 for this house its - it -

Mikey interrupts.

MIKEY

Nona. Listen to this guy. Listen to him!

Mikey slaps Mika on the back a bit too hard.

MIKEY

The house will sell. For 320. I know real estate. I live and breathe this stuff. This house will sell for 320. No doubt.

NONA

I knew it. That will set us up for something special in Ft. Lauderdale.

MIKA

Its not going to sell for that. Never going to sell. And even if it did, 320 gets nothing special in Ft. Lauderdale for that amount. Sorry. Nothing.

Mika looks to Mikey.

MIKA

Please, set the price lower. Please at least look at it before you set the price.

MIKEY

Why go low when you can go high and get the price you want. The price you need!

MIKA

Mikey, house is not worth that amount. It should be 240 to 245 at most. At most. Make your life. God, make our life easy. Just start at a reasonable price, sell it fast and get it done.

Mikey simply laughs and shake head.

MIKEY

Why 240 may I ask. Why that price?

MIKA

First, the interior is outdated. All the rooms, all the rooms need rennovations. All every last one. Have seen the popcorn ceilings in there. Its of a type never seen before - like Christmas ornaments.

MIKEY

Ahhhh.... but the house has a good layout. It has a great layout. You can't beat that. And a lot of people like that 70s stuff. Vintage. It is coming back.

MIKA

Again, You haven't been in this friggin house in 17 years. Why don't you walk through. Just imagine you are buyer. You have this mental calculator that figures out renos costs. 10, 20, 30, very quickly you get to 60, 80 thousand in renos to make house match other houses in this neighborhood happy.

MIKEY

Exactly, its a great neighborhood.

MIKA

Yeah, it is, it is. Have you looked at the comparables? Have you seen houses with this square footage? Look at how good they are on the interior. This is, a joke,

Mikey laughs.

MIKEY

Comparables. Nona, you did not tell me that Mika had a side hustle as a real estate agent. You should have told me!

NONA

Oh Mikey, lets go inside and look. The coffee maker is still there. Do you remember? The Bunn one. I made coffee and have dansih for you.

MIKA

I am not a fan of danish.

NONA

Mikey is.

Mika turning attention back to Mikey.

He points as he says this.

MIKA

Mikey, I go two blocks that way and find houses with the same amount of space, less traffic, no updates
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)
 needed, they go for 2-9-9. Why the
 hell would this go for 320.

MIKEY
 You forget about the intangibles.

MIKA
 What? What? What intangibles?
 What, that is on high traffic street
 with crappy interior. Is on Main
 Street. Mikey, Main Street. Every
 town has a Main street. It is
 always one thing; busy.

MIKEY
 Excactly, benefit one. Its on Main
 Street.

MIKA
 So?

MIKEY
 Zoned residential.

Mikey turns to look at Nona and points to house.

MIKEY
 And commerical.

MIKA
 So!

MIKEY
 You just doubled your market my
 friend. Doubled it. It could work
 for a family or professional or
 doctor or lawyer -

MIKA
 Yes, because lawyers are so
 interested in doing home renovations
 and not in sending you \$300 invoice
 for a half hour of work spent on
 sending out will reading date has
 been set. Yeah, they love
 renovations.

NONA
 Mika, please listen to Mikey.

MIKA
 What?

MIKEY
 Mika, Mika, lets look inside the
 (MORE)

MIKEY (CONT'D)

house. I am going to show how we
are going to get 3-2-0 for this.

Group heads up driveway to front door.

Mikey opens door to house with interior clearly out of
1971.

MIKEY

This house. This house! What a
layout, just as I remembered it.
People are going to love it.

MIKA

Or, or. They might just walk
through this door and think first
'This is a lot of work.'

Mikey disregards comment.

Sets coffee down and produces a camera.

He chats with Nona he then takes one pic.

He next heads to the kitchen and takes one pic, still
chatting with Nona.

Mika proceeds to walk through the mostly empty house.

Peeks into outdated bathrooms and heavily wood paneled
rumpus room with a massive, 1970s stereo player.

MIKEY

And whose bedroom was this?

NONA

Stellas. Stella. She had this wall
covered with posters of bands, it
was quite beautiful how she laid it
out. She was always an artist.
That's why she is Austin now.

MIKEY

Oh Austin, that's a place we might
want to move to! The market there
is so hot.

Mikey againk takes one picture of the bedroom room and
moves on.

Mika flustered announces to no one.

MIKA

One picture.

MIKEY

Hmmm?

MIKA

One pic. Each room you take one picture. Why not take more than that? You know, a selection to choose from. Different angles.

MIKEY

Again, I am a real estate agent. I know this stuff. One and done!

INT. KITCHEN

Nona is at the kitchen table.

NONA

They are all signed. All papers are signed. You are our agent Mikey!

Mika is resigned.

He also sits at the kitchen table.

MIKA

Ok. Great. Great!

MIKEY

Hey, where is the pool table? Is it still here? In the basement.

NONA

Yes, its still there! We couldn't sell it during the estate sale. It goes with the house.

MIKEY

Oh, bonus. Hey, I'm going to play a game.

Mikey heads to the basement with Nona.

NONA

Look, these pictures I painted for mothers day when I was in the fourth grade. I need to take these before we sell the house!

Mika is now alone in the kitchen.

Mika says to no one.

MIKA

Why not take more pictures.

INT. KITCHEN

In Mika and Nona's house.

MIKA sits At the kitchen table.

He has a laptop.

NONA constructs some type of complicated dessert.

MIKA

Still no photos. I got to call him.
I've got to. Got to.

Nona measures and then mixes.

NONA

Emmmm ... Ok, ok. We will call him.
You are so worried, its annoying.
He will sell the house.

MIKA

I know. I know. He will sell ...
just not sure when. What is his
number.

NONA

Just look on my phone! There, by
the mixer.

Mika finds a phone the by mixer.

He scrolls until he finds it.

Mika looks to see a cyrillic recipe on the counter.

Mika then punches in a number on his cell phone.

Mikey's voice is heard.

MIKEY

This is Mikey Derogai - the guy to
sell your house! How may I help
you.

MIKA

Mikey

MIKEY

Yes.

MIKA

Mikey.

MIKEY

Yes this is he, who is this?

MIKA

Mika. Nona. It's us, the house you are selling.

MIKEY

Oh, Mika, Nona! How are you! What number is this, I've not seen it before.

MIKA

Is my cell phone.

MIKEY

You are in the contacts buddy! Any calls on the house yet, anything?

MIKA

Mikey, why would people be calling us? You are the real estate agent,.

MIKEY

Well sometimes if they know the person selling, they call them and then you have to -

MIKA

Look, no one has called. And really - why would they - there is not single picture of the house.

MIKEY

What?

MIKA

On the site, the site, there's no pictures. None.

MIKEY

What? What?

MIKA

The HOUSE. The Realtors Plus site. There is not one figgin picture of the house. Not one. Three days Mikey.

Nona looks condescendingly.

He waves her off.

She is back to measuring for a complicated dessert recipe.

NONA

Liters to ounces, what the fuck. Why don't I know this!

MIKEY

Ohhhhh ohhhhh ... lemme check.

MIKA

See Mikey, you don't have to check.
I do that for you. There are no
pictures.

MIKEY

Ohhhh ... yeah ... this part. Ummm
... give it 10 minutes and check.
The pics look great. Hey, is Nona
there?

NONA

Hi Mikey! How many liters to the
ounce.

MIKEY

Let me check my phone -

Mika now sits at the table.

Mika is reading a book on small engine repair.

Nona is crouching and looking into an oven.

NONA

It's in. 60 minutes.

MIKA

At least there is no conversion on
that, eh?

NONA

There is, centigrade to fahrenheit.
It's an easy one though.

Mikey pauses from reading.

Looks at screen of laptop.

MIKA

Ok, ok. They are there. And they
...

Pauses again.

MIKA

God dam it. God dam it!

NONA

What? What now!

MIKA

Come. Come. Come look. Witness it.

She turns from the coffee maker.

She was making a pot.

Mika is smiling.

MIKA
Blurry. All are blurry.

NONA
What?

Nona comes closer to look.

MIKA
You don't have your friggin readers.
Trust me, every picture is blurry.
Every one. Every. How did he did
he do it. Not one, not two. All!
How.

Nona is back to the coffee.

NONA
Something is wrong with the
computer.

MIKA
Oh yeah, uh-huh. Something is wrong
the computer. Yeah. Ok.

NONA
Ok, something is wrong his camera
then. We need to tell Mikey.
Honestly ...

MIKA
Oh yes, his camera is broken. Sure.
Is broke. Uh-huh. Calling him -

Mika is back to dialing the number.

MIKEY
This is Mikey Derogai. The guy to
sell your house. How can I help
you!

MIKA
By not having blurry pictures.

MIKEY
What, who is this?

MIKA
Mika, Nona. Hello! Pictures are
blurry!

MIKEY

What pictures?

MIKA

Of the house! The house. All of the picture, except amazingly of the basement, are blurry. So if someone is interested in a pool table, dry basement, and rafters they are going to be very happy. Probaby lay out a bid on the spot.

Nona reads a magazine at the kitchen counter.

She shouts.

NONA

Mikey, something must be wrong with your camera!

MIKEY

Oh hi Nona! Yeah, ok, let me look at this.

MIKA

Why look, you said they looked great. Have someone else look. You said the pictures looked great.

MIKEY

Um ... um uh give me five minutes.

Both Nona and Mika sit at kitchen table in silence drinking coffee.

Nona happily pages through magazine.

NONA

They are doing a production on women's voting rights. That seems interesting!

MIKA

Yeah, what -

Nona's phone rings.

She answers and places into speaker mode.

MIKEY

Nona its Mikey, the pictures are not good.

MIKA

That we know. That we are aware of.

MIKEY

I don't know why. It's that camera.
That camera. They looked amazing
in screen on the camera -

MIKA

Who cares. When can we take more.
Is nice day, we can do it today or
tomorrow.

MIKEY

Well, it will have to be Monday.

MIKA

Its frigging Thursday Mikey!
Thursday.

MIKEY

Well, I am not in Aurora.

MIKA

Where the hell are you, Saigon?

MIKEY

No, Cleveland.

MIKA

Cleveland?

NONA

Cleveland! Oh, we have many
relatives there Mikey, I can tell
you where to go!

MIKEY

Oh, thanks Nona!

MIKA

Why the hell are you in Cleveland.
Thats like 4 hours away.

MIKEY

Oh, I'm taking the kids to a hockey
tournament. Ryan has a tournament
and I am taking Amber and Fisher
too. It's something!

NONA

Oh, Mikey that sounds like fun! I
always liked going on the trips with
the kids.

MIKEY

You would think it would be but you
spend so much time travelling, and
in the hotel, and at the tournament.
(MORE)

MIKEY (CONT'D)

But, but the hotel has a pool on the 12th floor so the kids love that. And then -

Mika interrupts.

MIKA

Yes, great, Cleveland. What about the pictures. When!

MIKEY

Well, Monday. Or maybe today or tomorrow. I would have to call someone at the office. I think maybe Elly could do it. Yeah, that could work. Do you want me to call Elly?

MIKA

Mikey, that would is good idea. That, is an actually good idea.

Nona looks disparagingly.

She shakes head at him.

MIKEY

Hey Fisher. Stop. STOP. Hey you have to stop that. Come on, now! Nona, Mikey, let me - Fisher give it to him - let me call Elly and then I will call you.

MIKA

That sounds good.

NONA

Ok, be safe Mikey. I will text you where to go!

MIKEY

Of course! I'll call like in a half hour. Fisher!

The phone call stops abruptly.

MIKA

I don't think -

NONA

This guy knows what he is doing. Yes, yes. You keep saying that. The problem was with the camera. It can be solved.

Mika pushes chair away and rises from the table.

MIKA

What the hell kind of names are those. Ryan, Fisher, Amber. Was it Amber? Soon, names will be Coyote and Shooting Star. Native Americans will say 'You have to take that from us too?'

NONA

Be one thing - one thing Mika - nice. That child never had a mother. Never.

MIKA

That child is selling that house.

INT. COFFEE SHOP

MIKA is surrounded by FRIENDS 1-3.

Others are there as well.

Two play a backgammon game.

One wears a Viet Name veteran hat.

MIKA

Bull shit. He did not have a mother when growing up. This, this is true. No mother for many years. But is not a 'sob story'. This is not Orphan Annie. Mother did not die in child birth. So it is fine.

FRIEND 2

Annie, she had Daddy Warbucks. That's no sob story either.

FRIEND 3

Warbucks, like was he a defense contractor? Never saw it. But I like the name. Warbucks.

Mika says the following.

Pronounces Tampa very badly.

MIKA

Fine. Live in Tampa.

FRIEND 2

What? Where? Who lives where?

MIKA

Tampa.

FRIEND 3

Are you saying Tampa?

MIKA

Yes, TAMPA, TAMPA, TAMPA BAY!
Buccaneers. TAMPA!

FRIEND 2

What in the hell does that have to do with anything you just said.

MIKA

Let me explain.

FRIEND 3

Tampa is great. Tampa's great! You guys get down there watch the sunset on the Gulf its amazing.

Viet Nam vet comments from the backgammon game.

VIET NAM VET

I liked riding my bike in Tampa a lot. When I did ride. They have these biker HOV lanes. It was wonderful.

FRIEND 3

What did you ride?

VIET NAM VET

I had a Heritage Softail. It was nice, not too heavy. You always have to be worried about the turns with heavy bikes. The Softail was fine. But the I went and bought a -
.

MIKA

Yes, yes. Tampa is amazing. Mikey's mother leave Ivan, the father, years ago. Why, not sure. Maybe she was cheating. Maybe she just did not want to be around Ivan ... or Mikey

Mika sips coffee.

MIKA

But she move there with a carpet installer. Remarried to the installer and had two more kids. Maybe come up once or twice year. But not to see Mikey so much, which I have to admit is odd. So, it is true, he have no mother, at least
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

not one that really wanted to see him.

FRIEND 3

Hey, man, that is rough. I mean, I can't. Like, I can't imagine what its like to know your mom is still around. And she has two other kids. But, she sort of could care less about you. That's gotta do something to you. It cannot be easy. No way.

MIKA

Yes, it did something to him. It made him an absolute moron. Ivan, the father, is not the brightest guy.

Mika sips his coffee again.

MIKA

The kid was a mess. The milk incident.

FRINED 2

The what incident? Mika, man, its called context man, context.

Freinds laugh.

MIKA

The milk incident is perfect example of why something wrong with him. Let me explain.

VIET NAME VET

Please do.

MIKA

The milk event. So, we are at church event. Church have a summer picnic. Big event. All families go. So - everyone is there. Many years ago, this is after Nicollette leaves Ivan, summer picnic. Not sure when - had to be the 90s sometime because Mikey was probably 6, 7?

Mika sips coffee again.

He then points to friends with index finger.

MIKA

I am sitting at a table. Crappy picnic table.

VIET NAM VET

Why was it crappy? Did you need to swing your legs over? I hate those ones.

FRIEND 3

I think they are all like that? Right?

VIET NAME VET

No, no, some of them have the benches you can pull back.

FRIEND 2

Yeah, but if people are already on the bench you still need to do the swing.

Mika ignores side conversation

MIKA

I am sitting at the table. Mikey comes over and sits across from me. Huge plate of food. And he has a chocolate milk bottle.

FRIEND 2

Like a glass one.

FRIEND 3

Old time glass one. That would be somethin. What kind of picnic is this!

MIKA

No! Not! Milk bottle. Plastic. Plastic. He sits across from. He has trouble with the cap. It's too hard for him to open. So, I am about to offer to open for him when he does this.

Mika mimics Mikey's actions for the frineds.

MIKA

He take milk bottle. Look at it. Shake it. Stare at it. Then, he take bottle and smash it on the table. Like he is smashing the cap to get it off, like its a beer bottle. Bang, bang, bang - hit top hard. Then he stops - and I still remember this - looks at it again and hits and smashes it again. I say 'Mikey, is screw top. Let me take it off for you.' He look at me
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

and grunt. Not say a word, mind you, just grunt. 'You sure you do not want me to help?' He grunt again and then he takes the bottle. Looks at it - and squeezes it. Then, he lifts it above his head.

FRIEND 2

By the power of greyskull!

MIKA

He smash as hard as he can. Cap come off. Chocolate milk go everywhere. I am soaked. He is soaked - but not nearly as much. And I say 'What the fuck are you doing! What the fuck!'

There is parent and child in a booth near.

Parent says.

PARENT

Hey, c'mon, kids. Right here?

MIKA

Sorry, sorry! Important story. Important.

Quietly and only to friends.

MIKA

Is Wednesday, 9:30, why are these kids not in school?

Then loudly again.

MIKA

I say 'I tell you cap screws off. Why did you not let me help!' And he starts bawling. Crying. So Ivan come over. 'Oh Mikey. Oh Mikey. Oh don't cry is all right.' Then to me 'Why you make Mikey cry! Why!' I say 'Me! He did this! I offered to help and take off the cap. All he do is grunt and smash stuff.' Then other people come over, the mothers mostly, and take care of him. A couple of them scold me 'He has no mother! Be kind Mika, be nice.'

Mika leans back and looks at ceiling.

MIKA

And that is what happened. Everyone 'nice' to Mikey. All people are nice to Mikey. Mikey is always right no matter what. Every time he do soemthing, Mikey is never wrong.

FRIEND 2

Friggin carpet installer.

MIKA

Exactly!

INT. REAL ESTATE OFFICE

At coffee station.

Pot of coffee made.

MIKEY ummages through cupboard.

He finds packet of Swiss Miss.

Huge smile.

Mixes coffee wtih swiss miss.

Co-worker comes in.

CO-WORKER

Running a marathon today Mikey?

MIKEY

Poor man's mocha! But, actually, I'm going to do the Aurora 5k this year! I start training in a couple weeks.

Co-worker raises eyebrow as he secures a cup of coffee.

Phone rings in cube.

MIKEY

I gotta get that.

Mikey heads to cube and grabs cell phone.

MIKEY

This is Mikey Derogai. The guy who will sell your house! How can I help you today?

INT. MIKA'S KITCHEN

NONA listens and pages through the magazine.

MIKA holds his cell phone.

MIKA

First, by putting my number in your contacts. With my name.

MIKEY

Who is this?

MIKA

Its Nona, Mika. You are on speaker. You texted us to call you at 10AM. You text Nona on her phone. This is Mika. This my phone.

MIKEY

Mika, Nona! So good to hear from you! I was just thinking about the house.

MIKA

We were thinking too. Any news, offers, anything?

MIKEY

No, no news.

MIKA

Um ... any questions for us? Any thoughts?

MIKEY

No, no, nothing. But I want to talk about two ideas. Two big ideas!

MIKA

Ok, we are listening. What are the ideas.

MIKEY

First, we need to lower the price. We must lower it.

MIKA

Ok, that I knew. What is the new price?

MIKEY

310. 310. Its a great price.

MIKA

Is still too high. Way too high. Make lower please!

MIKEY

No, no, no. It is a perfect price.

MIKA

Ok, but why not 300 or 299 or something like that. Why is 310 more perfect then those? And note, those are -

MIKEY

It's a buyers market right now. A buyers market. Yep. In the last month nothing is moving.

MIKA

Ok ... so a buyers market.

MIKEY

You know what that means - right?

MIKA

YES! I know what it means, I am not a moron. I know, I know. But Mikey, I do see houses selling online and that means -

Mikey ignores Mika's thought and plows on.

MIKEY

Ok great, so we lower the price. Now, second idea. Open house.

MIKA

YES! Of course, we should have done that weeks ago. Why do you put a house on the market and then not have open house, it makes no sense.

Mikey completely ignores Mika again.

MIKEY

I want to shoot this Sunday at 1PM. 1PM.

MIKA

Ok so ...

MIKEY

Is it ok with you?

MIKA

YES! Why would it not be ok? Of course.

MIKEY

Well some people get worried about having people going in their house, they want to lock up the valuables, worry about stuff being broken.

MIKA

Mikey, house is empty! Rememeber?
Katryn is dead - she is gone! We
sold all the stuff. Whatever is
left, they can steal!

Nona looks up from magazine and shakes head, looks
disgusted.

She then motions to talk.

MIKA

Wait, one second.

Four seconds pass with focus on Mikey.

He causally looks at picture of his kids at hockey
tournament on desk.

MIKA

Nona wants to be there. I have no
clue why. She wants to be there.

MIKEY

Of course! Of course! Yes she can
be there. Nona - I need some of
your coffee! Please! Just like you
made the last time.

NONA

Don't worry Mikey, I will make it!
I'll remember to bring cream and
sugar.

MIKA

Yes. Cream and sugar. In fact, she
will bring sweetened condensed
milk.

MIKEY

Oh that would be great. Nona, you
make the best coffee!

MIKA

Yeah, I know. I know. Have known
her for 32 years, great coffee.

MIKEY

OK, Nona be there at 12:30, we will
tidy the house.

NONA

Ok Mikey, will see you se you then!
I will text the day before to make
sure it's a go.

MIKEY

Bye, ciao!

MIKA

Bye.

Phone conversation ends.

MIKA

By tidy, does he mean to tear out
and retile all the bathrooms?
Remove 40 yards of shag carpet. Is
Jesus going to be a part of this
plan, should we have loaves of bread
and fishes?

Smiling, Nona pushes a dessert to MIKA

NONA

Have some dessert. Now in this
article, they explain how the
costumes are selected for the Met
Gala. It is fascinating how much
work goes into it.

Scene goes back to real estate office.

Mikey sips the last of the 'poor mans mocha' and simply
looks out the window.

INT. OF NONA AND MIKAS HOUSE

Day of open house.

MIKA wanders down hallway to bathroom.

Nona is inside working on hair.

MIKA

Buyers market. My ass buyers
marker. You know Lydia right?
Sevas daughter, yes?

NONA

Of course, yes I know her.

MIKA

I saw her at the supermarket. I
tell her about the house and she,
without me saying anything, just
that we are selling it she says "You
will have no problem - none - it is
a SELLERS market." She just buy a
house one month ago. Some street I
never heard of. Says its a sellers
marker. This guy, he does not know
what he is doing.

NONA

He does! Maybe the market changed?
Maybe when Lydia bought it, it was a
sellers market. And now its not!

Mika waves her off which she can see in the mirror.

MIKA

Bahh, in two months!

MIKA

Explain to me again, why do I need
to go this open house? Please.

NONA

Because I have to go to Irinia's
baby shower. Hello! I want to be
there to explain things to Mikey
about the house when arrives. But I
have to leave by 1PM.

MIKA

No, I know that, I know WHY you have
to leave. But why can't he just do
it? Why do I need to be there at
all?

NONA

To help Mikey. To help him if he
needs it.

MIKA

What help is he going to need?
Irinia, I do not understand why that
baby shower is even happening. It
is not even her first child.

NONA

Ok, what do you mean 'Why'. You
know exactly why she could not have
a shower for the first baby. Irinia
never got to have people shower here
with gifts and love. It is a
beautiful thing.

She continues to talk while looking in the mirror and
applying makeup.

MIKA

But she is not even married. Is she
even with this guy?

NONA

Yes, I am going to this baby shower.
And yes, she is with 'this guy.'
The live together and he will be
(MORE)

NONA (CONT'D)
there. His name is Martin. And one
final yes, you are going to that
open house.

MIKA
But what would I do there? Am I to
be some random guy at a table
drinking coffee 'Hey! How are you.'

Nona sips a smaller espresso cup of coffee on the bathroom
counter.

NONA
I don't want anyone messing with my
parent's house. Period.

MIKA
But Mikey is a grown man. A man who
can do things. He can ... drive to
Cleveland and get his kids asses to
a hockey tournament. He can handle
an open house.

Nona turns and faces Mika.

NONA
Listen, you are gonna go to that
open house. You watch the house.
You help Mikey.

MIKA
Fine fine. But I'm not making him a
second pot of coffee.

Mika walks down hallway. Makes one last call out.

MIKA
I am going out to the library. I
will be at the open house by 1
o'clock. Also, baby shower is for
when you are pregnant and married.
Pregnant and married.

EXT. OF TAN BRICK HOUSE

NONA'S car is in the driveway.

Multiple cars whiz by.

As MIKA walks up driveway a fat black cat hussles out of
garage.

It looks at Mika disdainfully and trots away.

He walks inside.

NONA

Oh Mika, Mikey was just telling me a terrific story about Amber and the kids and how they got locked out of the house on Black Friday.

MIKEY

Yes, they went out early and -

Mika interrupts.

MIKA

Yes, I'm sure it's a great story. How is the open house? How many people have stopped to look?

MIKEY

None, yet. Officially it hasn't started.

MIKA

Ok, but if people are interested wouldn't they be here already? Yes? Like to be the first ones to see it in person?

Nona ignoring Mikey.

NONA

I have to go Mikey. Good luck! Irninia's baby shower.

MIKEY

Ohhhh, she is having a shower. That is beautiful! Good for her.

NONA

I know, I know, she is so lucky.

MIKA

Yes, beautiful thing. Beautifyul thing. Nona, we need to talk before you go.

NONA

Ya, ya, ok, BYE MIKEY.

MIKEY

Ok, by Nona, And hey -

He says this as though telling a secret.

MIKEY

I won't tell Amber you ake the best coffee around.

NONA

Mikey!

Mika hustles here down the hallway leading out

MIKA

I just thought of something.
Something we need to talk about.
The gift.

NONA

What gift. What do you mean?

MIKA

Irinia, Irinia. Gift. How much to
give. Now a dinner or brunch at
Heffingers. Can cost no more than
\$15 dollars a plate. No more. I
looked online at the catering menu.

NONA

Oh come on!

MIKA

Gift should be no more than 50
dollars. No more.

Nona laughs as she continues walking.

NONA

You are crazy. You are nuts. No
one gives 50 dollars for a baby
shower! A 100 dollars at least.
Probably more. If you give 50, you
are cheap bastard. Even if you give
a 100 you sort of are. Besides, for
a baby shower you give a gift.

MIKA

How much did you spend? Mind you,
she is not even -

NONA

Married. I know. Mmmm. Let me
think. Baby swing, embroidered bids.

Nona stops to do imaginary math in the air.

NONA

At least 200.

MIKA

What!

NONA

Yes at least 200 dollars. Maybe
more.

MIKA
You can't give her that much.
That's crazy!

NONA
Well I did. You stay, watch house,
help Mikey.

MIKA
What, drink coffee?

NONA
Help Mikey.

Nona leaves through garage, impeccably dresses.

Mika heads to kitchen.

Pours cup of coffee and sit with Mikey.

MIKEY
Cream?

10 minutes later.

Mikey is droning on.

MIKEY
Mika, you would not believe it. You
would not believe this goal.

MIKA
Yes, you must be there to
appreciate.

MIKEY
He, he just from around the back of
the net, he takes the puck one way,
goes the other then and bang,
backhands it in. Oh man, just
beautiful. The team calls that play
the Monte Cristo because its so
good. Its that good!

MIKA
Yes, wonderful. Fisher must be very
talented.

MIKEY
Oh you have no idea. Look at this -

Door opens.

A young couple with a child enters the house.

Mikey springs into action and greets at the door.

Mika stands and motions to go but avoids the couple.

MIKEY

Welcome, welcome! So glad to have you here to see this house. I am Mikey. Who do I have the pleasure of seeing here today!

SARAH

Sarah

JOHN

John. And this is our son

Mika is in the kitchen.

Eyes closed and listening as he stands by the sink.

John
Atticus.

Mika nods and smiles. Opens his eyes and looks to the backyard.

MIKEY

Hey little guy! You want to see the house! Come on - come on in! This house was built for kids! It was build in 68. Well, you probably know the specs, but what's best about this house. The layout and flow. Just give it a look! If you have any questions, just give a holler!

The couple wanders around and looks at stuff.

A grossly outdated living room.

There is a massive white brick fireplace with smoke stains about the outside of it.

The husband looks at the bookshelf adjoining it.

Mikey appears behind him.

He gives no social space and becomes a member of their walk through.

MIKEY

How far along are you on the journey?

JOHN

Excuse me. Journey?

MIKEY

The house hunting journey. That journey!

JOHN

Oh, oh. Just starting. In fact we just happened to be driving by and decided to give it a look. It seemed nice. We liked the brick exterior, nice tan bricks..

MIKEY

Exactly. It's almost got a touch of strawberry red, it's very nice. Oh, all the books and all the items are still for sale. Just make an offer if you are intereted!

John peruses a book.

JOHN

Uh, my Russian is a real rusty. Don't think a dictionary in cyrillic will do me much good.

MIKEY

Its Ukrainian actually!

Sarah goes out back with child.

Mikey immediately foolws.

MIKEY

Now this, this is a great yard. Great yard. Perfect for the summer and hosting parties.

SARAH

Really, how?

MIKEY

What do you moean ok? All the fences are there, its private. Hosting!

SARAH

Well, it's really narrow. And, uh, there is no deck. Just a big concrete ... slab. Which is ... interesting. Honey, don't fall on that.

Atticus is attempting to hop scotch on solid concrete bench.

MIKEY

Ya know, a more confined backyard is actually better. You want it to feel cozy. Your guests will mingle better.

SARAH

Um, yeah, I enver thought of it like that. Never thought like that. Atticus, stop, please.

MIKEY

Come on, let's take a look at the dining room. Hey, Atticus, where does the bounce house go!

ATTICUS

Oh, we own one of those! We own our own! Its so fun!

SARAH

Not next to the concrete slab. Those things tip.

All eneter the house.

Sarah and child decidedly do not go to the dining room.

Mikey enters it to find John.

He is staring at the chandelier.

MIKEY

Ahhh, you like it? That is high end, high end chandelier. Top of the line.

JOHN

I was actually thinking its was kind of ugly. I mean, this is right out of 1972. You can see, they were going for like a French provincial look. But it's all wrong.

MIKEY

No, no. Top of the line. This stuff is coming back, big! It is big right now. You go to a vintage shop and that same chandelier, you are looking at at least 600 or 800.

Mika stays out of eye sight but always with ear shot.

Sarah calls from the window.

SARAH

This window is ... impossible. To open.

Atticus runs through the house destructively.

Mikey is now somewhat confused.

Does not know who to address next.

MIKEY

Watch out little guy. What window. What?

SARAH

Yeah this one. Its the third window I've tried to open and no luck.

MIKEY

Let me see.

Mikey leverages a crank handle of a casement window..

Full weight hit.

A not so good cracking sound is heard as the window pops open.

MIKEY

See, see, it works fine. Just need to put some oomph into it.

JOHN

Wow, uh, this is an old kitchen.

SARAH

Is that ... is that a bay of flourescent lights. Oh my God. I feel like I'm in an Amazon warehouse.

The center of the kitchen is dominated by a massive bay of flourescent lights with an old, discolored plastic covering.

The ligts are like an island of flourescent.

MIKEY

No, no, it's not old. No way. I've sold many many houses. This kitchen is not old. Believe me I have seen old. You have no idea! It's in great condition. A little paint. A new fixture. It's spot on.

Sarah walks to the stove.

The stove is brown, clearly of the 70s.

SARAH

No ... yes. No ... yes. Yes! This is. This is exactly the stove my grandmother had. The exact one. Its got that brown color that fades a bit away from the edges. Wow.

She is now peering into the stove.

JOHN

What the hell is this?

MIKEY

Oh, the microwave!

A behemoth microwave sits below a cabinet.

It looks the size of washing machine.

MIKEY

See, its got great capacity. Great capacity. I am pretty sure you can microwave like a 20 pound turkey in it. At least. 20 pounds for sure.

SARAH

I've ... a microwaved turkey. It sounds terrible but I almost want to try it. What would it belike?

Mika just listens from other rooms but close to the front door.

He wants to be unseens but observing.

He carries the house listing sheet to appear as a potential buyer.

Mikey is smiling and motions to the couple.

MIKEY

Come on. The best part!

He motions by the kitchen hallway to follow.

SARAH

What? What part.

MIKEY

The upstairs!

SARAH

This hallway is so dark.

MIKEY

No, no, the ligthing is fine. Just needs a bigger bulb.

JOHN

Actually, it's a long hallway. It needs more lights.

MIKEY

Nope, just a stronger bulb. You'll see!

Sarah and John are startled.

They step into the bathroom at the top of the stairs.

MIKEY

Now, this bathroom. Hi-end. Everything in here, high end.

JOHN

Yeah ... of a time.

Mikey looks perplexed.

He plows on.

MIKEY

They simply don't make stuff like this any more. No way. Quality. Quality. The stuff today is crap. Look at this shower. Two shower heads - two!

JOHN

Wow, I can't beleive they tiled the ceiling.

SARAH

With pink tiles.

MIKEY

Exactly! They spared no expense! I mean none. Just crank up that shower on hot and you can make this bathroom a sauna. With the tiles, it radiates heat.

SARAH

A pink toilet.

MIKEY

Oh, those can be painted. I know someone. Easy fix.

John from the hallway.

JOHN

Wow. Wow.

MIKEY

Master bedroom. Master. Its huge.

JOHN

It's wood paneled. Who wood panels their bedroom? Are you sure this isn't the den or something? But it can't be because there's the closet.

MIKEY

No, its a bedroom. And do checkout the closet. What I like about the wood, it's warm. Is a warm feeling, like a Swiss chalet. Warm.

SARAH

Its like a lodge feel. I sort of get it.

Atticus rushes in and pounds on the wood.

MIKEY

Hey little guy!

Downstairs Mika works the window and nothing happens.

The handle just spins.

He looks disgusted.

Upstairs all enter a new room.

MIKEY

What did I tell you. High end. They do not make sound systems like this anymore. No way. This - it comes with the house. With the house! Listen to it.

Mikey turns on the stereo.

Classic music pumps out at a high volume.

JOHN

It's the best I've ever heard.

MIKEY

Look around some more! This whole place is primo. One other thing, look out this window. Those, those are all 500 thousand dollar houses. Right behind you. Right behind you!

John and Sarah nod.

The couple leaves to explore more of the house while Atticus runs like mad.

We then see Mika and Mikey talking in the kitchen.

MIKEY

They say that after 10 minutes you should not drink the coffee. No matter how good the caraffe is. 10 minutes! But - I can never tell any difference.

Mika looks at the listing printout when Sarah and John come back in.

Atticus can be heard in the background playing with the sound system.

Mika pretends to be a buyer.

MIKA

Well thank you for the description, I am going to look around.

JOHN

Well thank you for showing us this house!

SARAH

Yeah, it was great! Atticus - get down here!

MIKA

I am going to look around the front.

Mika holds up the listing pretends to read and walks down the front hallway.

As he exits you can hear the conversation between Sarah, John, and Mikey.

Mika begins to weed by the entrance steps.

Eventually the couple exits.

JOHN

Its nice. It is nice. The layout is great. ATTICUS!

SARAH

Yeah, I like it. It needs a lot of work. ATTICUS GET OUT HERE!

JOHN

Uh - ya think! It's way overpriced.

SARAH
No, no. Its vintage. Vintage!

JOHN
Oh, thanks Mikey

John looks at the card

JOHN
Derogai.

Atticus tears down the driveway leaping and breaking a tree branche on the tree along the way.

SARAH
John, stop him before he gets to the STREET! John.

Mika ignores them and heads into the house.

He arrives in the kitchen to see no one.

Then, Mikey re-enters.

MIKEY
Oh, had to turn off the stereo. The sound on that thing is amazing. I might take it.

Mikey then heads to the fridge and pulls out a massive sub.

He proceeds to unroll the paper and takes a huge bite.

He looks out the kitchen window he opened earlier.

MIKA
Yes. Well?

MIKEY
Oh ... that ... that went really well!

MIKA
Really, you think it went well? Why? Why you think that?

MIKEY
They had many questions - and I answered them all. All of them!

MIKA
Really? What questions did they have?

MIKEY

Oh, they thought stuff was wrong.
But I explained how it was good.
Head em' off at the pass. Make a
negative a poistive. Works every
time.

MIKA

So, now what?

MIKEY

They will offer. I guarantee it.
Probably tomorrow morning. Monday
morning.

MIKA

I don't know Mikhail. They seemed
not so interested.

MIKEY

Mika. Mika! I do this for a
living! I can read people. They
are interested. I know it.

As he bites the sub Mika leans to the window.

He spins a clearly broken handle.

MIKA

I think ... you might have broke
this.

Mikey looks disbelieving.

He then spins it.

Spins it again.

MIKEY

Oh, its an easy fix. Easy fix! I
know exactly what is wrong.

INT. COFFEE SHOT

MIKA is with his FRIENDS.

MIKA

And that ... that is what happened
at the open house. But I suspect
this will happen next.

Friend 3 looks at watch.

FRIEND 3

Mika, Mika, I gotta go. Sorry.

FRIEND 2

Where are you going?

FRIEND 3

I gotta get a blood draw. And if I wait another half hour, then the senior center mini-bus comes and its impossible.

FRIEND 2

You ok - blood daw?

FRIEND 3

Diabetes. Just that. I have a doctors appointment next week.

FRIEND 2

I never knew that. One or two?

FRIEND 3

Two. Two man.

FRIEND 2

My brother-in-law has that.

Friend 3 rises

FRIEND 3

Yeah a lot of people do. Like half the country dude.

FRIEND 2

No, no, no. He is Type 1 though. My wife is always worried about this guy. She is calling like crazy. 'You ok? Did you take your insulin? What's your A1C?' He never takes care of himself. So, its like I'm living with Type 1 diabetic.

FRIEND 3

He got one of these?

Friend 3 shows a glucose monitor on his upper arm.

FRIEND 2

Don't ... I know what that is.

Friend 3 laughs.

FRIEND 2

He has one. Lazy ass. My wife, get this, wanted to set my phone up so I got alerts on his A1C from his monitor. So I would be the one to call or text and remind him. 'Fuck no!' I said.

Frined 3 leaves.

FRIEND 2

All right, I'll see you tomorrow. I think. Maybe. We'll see. You gonna be here?

MIKA

I think.

Friend 2 gets up and leaves as well.

Mika sits alone.

He then sees the same person with the children.

Earlier he had scolded Mika for his language..

MIKA

Hey, hey, homeschooler.

The adult looks at Mika.

MIKA

Yes you. I know you are listening to story. What do you think?

HOMESCHOOLER

I have a name. It's Randy. You know that. It's a long story. All your stories are long. But it's ... interesting at least.

MIKA

I have no choice. No choice but to help. I watched a special by Deepak.

Homeschooler then looks to Mika.

His children quitely read.

He holds up an index finger, ponders, and then asks.

HOMESHOOER

Deepak? Do you mean Deepak Chopra?

MIKA

Yes, yes. Chopra. Chopra. Deepak Chopra.

Homeschooler then sets down his sandwich he held in the other hand.

He then turns to look at Mika.

HOMESCHOOLER

You watch Deepak Chopra.

MIKA

Yes, on the PBS. He say you need to push the thoughts out of your mind. Do not think about bad things until there is a positive. Everything in life is a journey but you have to find the light at the end of that jhourney. So, that made sense to me, it is what I do.

HOMESHOOLER

Wow. Ok. Well. Wow. For the record here I hear what you guys say. I don't just park my kids at Dunkin Donuts. We start school at 06:30. This is just a break.

MIKA

Oh, I am sorry! I am sorry. They read beautifully, better behaved than all the other animal kids I see.

HOMESCHOOLER

I also have a PhD and they are getting an educaiton 100 times better than any school.

MIKA

PhD? PhD? In what, what?

HOMESHOOLER

Philosophy.

Mika nods.

Silently sips coffee.

His Viet Nam friend had been using the bathroom and returns.

He is trying to figure out cross word.

He proclaims.

VIET NAM

Five letter for 'Ensures a good relationship with your neighbors'.

All ignore him except one of the children who, without looking up, says.

CHILD

Fence.

MIKA

Ok, see, that is problem. Now it makes sense. See that is why your wife has to work. You should have gotten a PhD in something more ... um ... marketable.

HOMESCHOOLER

It's marketable. Trust me, it is. I got a PhD because I wanted to get it. Not because I was looking for big pay day. It's because I wanted it. And what the hell degree do you have, by the way.

MIKA

Oh, I have a degree. But do not get me started. You have asked the wrong question. Have a degree in what you call in America civil engineering. Best institute in Ukraine. Best by far. But they would not accept the courses.

Homeschooler laughs.

HOMESCHOOL

Probably some two year technical college - -

Mika is quickly annoyed.

MIKA

Hardly! Four year program! Heavy math, physics, all of it better, BETTER, than degree is US.

VIET NAM

I gotta go.

Mika looks at watch.

MIKA

Yes, I as well. Ok, philosophy, that story is for another day. You have to wait. By boys!

Mika waves bye to two children.

They continue to read unflinchingly.

One has Lake Wobegon Days.

The other the autobiography of Steve Young.

INT. NONA AND MIKA SIT ON SCREENED IN BACK PORCH. NONA IS WATCHING A TV MOUNTED ON THE WALL. A TALK SHOW IS ON

WITH THE HOSTS WITH THE HOSTS SIPPING COFFEE AND LAUGHING.
MIKA READS THE PAPER.

NONA
They are going to have Miley Cyrus
on next.

MIKA
Yes, Miley.

NONA
I think she has a beautiful voice.
Really, just beautiful.

MIKA
Well if she is on this show I doubt
much she is going to sing. You know
we must call him.

Nona continues watching and laughs.

NONA
Ok, ok. Call him.

Mika call on phone and places into speaker.

NONA
I don't need to hear this! I am
watching ths sheow. Go inside! Or
take it off speaker.

Mika waves her off and takes the phone off speaker.

MIKEY
Hello, this is Mikey Derogai. The
guy who will sell your house! How
can I help you!

MIKA
Two ways, first put my firggin
number in your contacts so you know
its me. Mika. Second, you can sell
my house! As in, actually sell it.

MIKEY
Mika! Wait, are you looking to sell
your house too?

MIKA
Mike, the house you are selling for
us. Just that one. Updates?
ANything?

MIKEY
Well ... no, no nothing. How is
Nona?

MIKA

She is fine great. What about that couple, that couple you were so such of at the open house. Anything?

MIKEY

Well, they are young. You and, like, afriad. Typical first time home buyers. Can't recognize a value when its staring them in the face. Just can't see the forest for the -

MIKA

Mikey, I do not think they are young and stupid. They have a kid, they probably have a house. They probably want more kids and a bigger house.

MIKEY

Yeah, yeah, maybe. Maybe that.

MIKA

So

MIKEY

So ... what?

MIKA

So what do we do now? The house, the house. What now. We do want to sell the damn thing.

MIKEY

Ohhh of course. Of course.

MIKA

What is going on over there, is this a bad time? What are you doing?

MIKEY

No, no! Its a fine time to talk. Here is what I think. I still think \$310 is the right numberr. But ... a house gets stale.

MIKA

Stale.

MIKEY

Yeah, stale. On the market. People who are looking know about it and just zip right past it. I think if we take it off the market for two

(MORE)

MIKEY (CONT'D)

months and put it back on, then ...
we might find ourselves in a sellers
market.

MIKA

Are you out of your mind! Take it
off the market. Mikey, what if
there are people who like the house,
who want the house, but this voice
in head, that voice, it says 'This
house is great but costs too much.'
Damn it, cut the price a lot, get
reasonable price and move it.

NONA

Be nice! Be kind. Oh, Miley is on
after this commercial.

MIKEY

But you want to maximize profit.

MIKA

Yeah, I know. Maximize what? We
have no skin in this game.
Everything we get is profit - all.
All is profit.

MIKEY

Oh ... Nona, is this what you want?

MIKA

You are not on speaker!

Nona talking louder but watching the TV.

NONA

Mikey, I can hear you! I trust you.
Let's keep the price at \$310 for ...
two weeks. Two more weeks. Then we
lower it.

MIKEY

Nona, that is a terrific idea!

MIKA

I thought this house is stale. Now,
two weeks is a good idea. Why?

NONA

Mikey, we will see you on Sunday at
church. We can talk more then. I
need to see what Miley says.

MIKEY

Oh sorry Nona, I am out of town this
weekend.

Mika mutes phone

MIKA

Real estate agent who is always away
on weekend!

Mika unmutes

MIKEY

Taking Amber and the kids to the
Poconos.

MIKA

What, no hockey tournament?

MIKEY

Oh no, thats over, thankfully! This
is sort of celebration of the season
... sort of!

MIKA

Poconos. Why the Poconos? What are
they?

MIKEY

Oh, a resort town in Allegheny
Pennsylvania! Really fun place.
You and Nona should go! I have a
timeshare there.

NONA

I would love to go Mikey. Mika,
come, watch, Miley is going to sing.
Come.

INT. CHURCH. SUNDAY CONGREAGATION IN A UKRANIAN ORTHODOX
CHURCH. THE PRIEST IS AT THE ALTAR.

PRIEST

And, of course, first Sunday of the
month so we have donuts and coffee
in the congregation room.

Moves to congregation room. Families and older folks are
piled in a line awaiting free donuts and coffee.

IVAN

Father, I am blessed. I blessed.

PRIEST

Of course you are Ivan. Of course.

IVAN

Truly, I am blessed. I have a
wonderful wife, made me a new man 12
years ago. A new man. Have
(MORE)

IVAN (CONT'D)
 beautiful children and grand
 children. I just think about it the
 other nihgt.

PRIEST
 Thought what?

IVAN
 I have a child who is a lawyer, an
 engineer, and a real estate agent.
 I was driving on the freeway. The
 other day. And there is a
 billboard. One it ... my child.
 Mikey. He is on it. And I think
 'That's my son!'

Mika listens in the background and finally can hold back
 no longer.

MIKA
 Really. You are blessed. Really.

IVAN
 Yes, I just said I am.

MIKA
 Let me ask you something prefict.
 Just one question. What makes a
 successful real estate agent.

PRIEST
 Um ... they sell houses! Or help
 people houses.

MIKA
 'They sell houses.'

IVAN
 What? What you talking about??!!

Ivan to his wife.

IVAN
 What is he talking about?

MIKA
 Successful real estate agents, they
 sell houses.

IVAN
 Yes, we know that Mika!

MIKA
 So, if a real estate agent has a
 house for three months and gets no
 (MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)
walkthroughs, no calls, no offers.
Is that successful? Is it?

People taking in the conversation look confused at one another. Ivan sets down his coffee.

IVAN
Wait wait wait wait wait. This
about Nona's house! Isn't it? This
is about her house. Nona, is this
about your house?

Nona looks from her conversation but has no clue what is transpiring.

NONA
What?

MIKA
Has nothing to do with the house
house. Is just a ... a how do they
say ... hypothetical question. Does
that make a successful real estate
agent.

IVAN
I'll tell you right now as I stand
here - Mikey is good real estate
agent. Good agent! He has sold
100s of houses. 100s! He drives a
BMW! He will have NO PROBLEM
selling Nona's house.

MIKA
First, its our house. Second, all
he need to do is sell the house.
Right.

PRIEST
Look, I'm just a priest. I don't
about know real estate and all that.
But have faith in God that it will
come to be.

MIKA
Then all he needs do is sell the
house. That is it. Just sell the
house.

Nona looks to Mika not full hearing eveything.

IVAN
He WILL see that house! He will
sell it. Maybe, maybe, if you had a
better house it is easier to sell.

MIKA

Believe me, the house is fine.
There is something else that is not
so fine that makes it hard to sell.

IVAN

What the

Ivan then pushes Mika. Mika pusehs back. Priest steps
in.

PRIEST

Please, please. 17 years we have
done this and this is the first
fight at donut day. Please!

Ivan wave off priest.

IVAN

Is not fight. Is minor
disagreement. (pointing to Mika).
We will sell Nona's house. He will.

MIKA

Our house. Not just Nona.

IVAN

He will sell the piece of shit - you
do not worry.

INT. CAR RIDE HOME. NONA AND MIKA WITH MIKA DRIVING.
NONA FLUSTERED.

NONA

Why did you do that. Why? Why,
why, why, in a church!

MIKA

It was just a minor disagreement.
And because he is is an idiot and I
could stand it no longer.

NONA

But in church, Mika, really. We
know these people. I am taking a
bus trip with Mila this week to the
casino! Oh I cannot go.

MIKA

You can go. You go. I only spoke
the truth.

NONA

And physically pushed it.

MIKA

No, no, no, no! Not that! Ivan pushed first.

NONA

Children. Children. Have not had these problems since we had 10 years old in the house. This is EXACTLY how I would feel when they would do something stupid in public. And what do you mean 'spoke the truth.'

MIKA

Ivan. Proclamations. 'I am blessed. I am blessed.' Daughter is a lawyer, yes, this is true. But a DUI defending attorney. You see the adds. And the other son is NOT an engineer by the way.

NONA

What do you mean? Why do you even care?

MIKA

No, engineer goes to four year so of college. He went to technical school for two years to be a facilities engineer. Do you know what a facilities engineer is? Do you? They are glorified -

Phone rings. Nona immediately hits screen to send it to speaker.

NONA

Hello.

MIKEY

Mika?

NONA

Mikey! It is Nona! We just saw your father at church.

MIKEY

Oh, thats great. Great! I have other news. We ... have ... an ... offer!

MIKA

Holy crap.

NONA

Mikey - that is great! What is the price.

MIKEY

Um ... I don't know. I don't know!

MIKA

How could you not know? Isn't an offer typically a number?

MIKEY

Oh yes, yes, Yeah. It is. They set it as a PDF and my phone is not reading PDFs. So I want -

MIKA

Whatever. When can you read the thing.

MIKEY

We are coming home from the Poconos right now. I'll know tonight.

NONA

Mikey - this is great. You will stop by in the morning. Tomorrow. I will have coffee and cake. And it will be a price reveal.

MIKEY

Oh yeah.

NONA

How were the pocnos.

MIKEY

Oh Nona, you have to go. You need to make Mika take you there. I feel completely re-energized. Completely!

Mika rolls eyes and continues driving as Mikey and Nona make more small talk.

EXT. MIKA AND NONA'S HOUSE. YOU SEE MIKEY'S FINGER REACH FOR AND PRESS DOORBEL.

MIKA

Come in Mikey. Come in.

MIKEY

Hello, hello, hello. Say hello to the guys who is going to sell your house!

MIKA

Yes, hello.

NONA

Oh Mikey, come to the kitchen.
Come, get some coffee.

MIKEY

Oh wow, what type of cake is that?

NONA

It is a new thing they have the
Price Rite. It is cake in a cup.
Its great! Try it. Try it!

MIKEY

Ok!

MIKA

How about we get the price.

Mikey scarfing down cake.

MIKEY

Oh, the price is low. But we can
work it.

MIKA

What is the price

NONA

Yes, the price

MIKA

285.

MIKA

That's an amazing price.

He stares at Mikey unbelieving.

MIKA

That is an AMAZING price.

NONA

Oh Mikey, that is great. Is great
price!

MIKEY

I printed the contract. They
actually sent over a contract.
Sometimes they do a verbal, 'You
gonna even consider this?' But look
a contract.

Mika takes contract and begins to read it.

NONA

How did you do it Mikey? Did you
(MORE)

NONA (CONT'D)

know these people? Did you show the house last week?

MIKEY

No, no. They saw the house, they saw the pictures and they were good with it.

NONA

It is amazing. I wonder if we should counter. No, we should not. We should start looking in Ft. Lauderdale. Mika, you know the markkets, what does \$285 get us?

MIKA

Not much I think.

MIKEY

The people seem great. They even sent a note. I printed that too. Listen to this 'Dear Owner of 6722 Main Street, We love your house! From the second we saw the strawberry blonde brick and backyard we knew it would be perfect for our family and Amos.'

MIKA

Amos. Who is Amos? What is Amos? Is that a child?

MIKEY

No. Maybe? I don't think so. I think its the dog.

Mika still reading the contract.

MIKA

Or maybe the cat.

MIKEY

'We love everything about the house. It will be perfect for our move back to Aurora. We hope so much you accept this offer. This is the home where I family will grow. Sincerely, Theresea Ann Miller-Marjean.'

Mika places hand to forehead. He walks to Mikey and places hand on shoulder. Looks him in the eyes and says, smiling.

MIKA

Oh, fuck.

MIKEY

What?

Nona, livid.

NONA

Wait, read that again. Again!

MIKEY

'Dear Owner of '

NONA

No, not that part. The nmae. The name. Just the name.

MIKEY

Theresea Ann Marjean-Miller.

MIKA

Wow. Wow.

NONA

Give me that letter now. Oh ...
give me that letter.

MIKEY

Whats going on.

He reads the name slowly

MIKEY

Theresea Ann Marjean-Miller

NONA

Let me guess. Oh, let me guess.
Ms. Theresa Ann Marjean-Miller wants
to be closer to grandmother. Hmmm
... how nice. How nice. Want to
help and take care of bitch
grandmother.

Mikey happily.

MIKEY

Oh, so you know them! Yes, yes.
The real estate agent mentioned
that! I thought it was really
sweet. Her grandmother lives right
behind the house. So, whe want to
extend the back walk and connect -

Nina interrupts

NINA

Mikey, she will put in NOTHING. Not
one damn thing. We will never
(MORE)

NINA (CONT'D)
 NEVER ... sell to MAR-JEAN. I need
 to call my sister right now.

Mika sighs. Sits at the table and begins to eat one of
 the cakes in the cup. He then pushes one toward Mikey.

MIKA
 Here.

In the background you hear Nona rattling off details.
 Then, loudly, you hear 'MAR-JEAN' and then again
 'MAR-FUCKING-JEAN'

MIKEY
 What ... is going on.

MIKA
 Oh Mikey. You have done many things
 wrong with selling this house. Many
 things. But this - you did nothing
 wrong. Could not have seen it
 coming up. Could not. When I heard
 that name - I knew - I knew. Not
 good. The cake is good though.

MIKEY
 Who is Marjean? Why won't she sell?

MIKA
 Mikey, I cannot make a coffee strong
 enough to discuss. You need a real
 drink.

Mika heads to a liquor globe in the adjacent dining room.
 He returns with a litre of Seagrams VO. He then pours it
 into Mikey's coffee.

MIKEY
 Oh, I only drink clear hard liquors.

Mika ignores the proclamation.

MIKA
 How was the Poconos.

The scene progresses with Mika and Mikey talking at the
 table.

MIKEY
 So now, Fisher is not sure if he
 likes hockey better than lacrosse.

MIKA
 Hmmm, what a problem. What
 problems.

MIKEY

Exactly! He can't possibly be on both travel teams.

MIKA

Oh no, no, not possible. What is a travel team?

Nona enter.

NONA

Well she agrees. We cannot sell the house. We WILL NOT sell the house to them. No. We burn the house down before we sell to them?

MIKEY

Why? Why not? Honestly ... it might be the best offer we get.

Mikey looks to Mika

MIKEY

The house might be priced too high.

Mika nods and sips his coffee.

MIKEY

Can we not just sell this?

NINA

No. Mikey. No. We cannot. No, we will not sell the house to them. Never.

Nona sits at the table. Mikey looks to the silent Mika and Nona. Mika sips his coffee and flips through a magazine.

MIKEY

Um ... why? WHY not? It might be the best offer we get.

MIKA

Tell the story. Explain. Or I will.

NONA

I will gladly explain. Many years ago, my mother had an herb garden in the back of the house. This was her pride and joy. You know the brick path. There were filled with flowers and herbs on the side leading to the bitch neighbor. In the very back were the herbs. And let me tell you, these were special.

She points to Mikey

NONA

When my mother left the Ukraine she was a flight out of a communist contry. And in her purse were the herbs. The ones from her parents gardent. She save six type. You used them for everything. Seasoning, teas, everything. They were in her purse as small seedlings wrapped in damp knapkins. Somehow. Somehow. She make it through customs in the U.S. And when she was settled at her cousing, she planted those seedlings. And they lived. For her, this was home. These herbs were home. They were home. When she gets to the house in main street, she plants those herbs in the back gardent. It is the only place in the U.S. you can get these. The only place.

MIKEY

Wow.

NONA

Yes, wow. Every year she save the seeds and plant them to grow more and more. She had everything. She had one type of mint, one type. Ukranian mint. That one was - what did that bithc call - what was the name Mika?

MIKA

Invasive

NONA

Yes, 'invasive'

MIKEY

Invasive. It takes over.

NONA

Exactly. If you do not control it, weed it, then it takes over. So, one afternoon I am in the back with morthor weedking, watering. Marjean comes over. She says "What is that?" point ot eh mint. My mother says "Its mint. It's wonderful! Use it in salads, dry it and mis it with chamomile tea." And Marjean says 'Well, its everywhere in my (MORE)

NONA (CONT'D)

garden.' And she points to her piece of shit garden. Which, I mind you, she never tended to. Always got the Mexicans to do the work. Annuals, mulch, she never planted a damn thing. So my moht says 'I will weed it, Marjean, its not a problem.' And I remember Marjean, she lift up her nad and says 'Well, I can't be expected to weed. I can't' And my mother says 'I will weed, I will weed' Marjean then says 'Don't worry - I will take care of it. Don't worry.' And she walks away. I still remember her fat ass walking away.

Nona sips coffee and reflects. Then dives into description.

NONA

So my mother thinks nothing of it. One week passes, two weeks pass. Then she comes in one day and says "I think, I think something is happening to the garden. The plants in the back, they look yellow. Not good.' Two days later entire herb garden, dead. Dead. Dead dead dead. So I go with her to look. And Marjean come out. My mother says 'My garden. My garden. What happened?' Marjean admits she had the Mexicans working for Andrews spray and kill 'weeds'. She says most my mothers herbs are invasive. So they spray our yard!

MIKEY

They can't do that.

NONA

I know! We know! Marjean swears they did not spray mother's garden. Bu we know. We know thye did. My mother, she sit at back window and look at garden and cry. Cry, cry, cry for monts. And nothing - nothing - grows there for two years. Just dead, yellow, for two years. Mother finally got kale to grow there. When she ate the kale she tasted the week kill and threw it out. She had an amazing sense of smell. She never plant there again. Eventually it turned to grass.

MIKEY

So how did they make restitution?

NONA

What? Never. No apology. No nothing. My father tell Marjean's husband to stay off property. He only says "Hmmmph." That's all. 'Hmmmph'.

Then she says directly to Mikey

NONA

Mikey, you have done a fine job selling the house. Fine job. But this offer. These people. No - no we cannot sell to them. Ever.

MIKEY

Ever?

MIKEY

This contract is good for 24 hours. You have to respond. I mean - that's it. You really me to say ... no.

NINA

Yes.

MIKA

No.

NINA

Yes!

Mika flips through magazine.

MIKA

No!

NINA

Mikey - decline now. Now!

MIKEY

No, no, no - let's just wait. Take a deep breath. Yes. Marjean is bad - clearly a devil - we know. But let's just think. Four months its been on the market and this is our first offer. Maybe we should take it.

NINA

Mikey, decline the offer. Give me the phone - I gladly tell
(MORE)

NINA (CONT'D)
Marjean-Miller where to stick the offer.

MIKA
Just ... give it the night. Just one night. Think about it. Marejean-Miller is not Marjean. She is some granddaughter.

NINA
Granddaughter. She is the same blood. You know that Marjean still lives there.

MIKA
Yes, I know. Yes. Can we just sell this thing.

NINA
Never.

MIKEY
What about one night? Just think about it over the night. We decide in the morning.

NONA
Ok ... ok. One night. Just ... one night.

Nona leaves the room.

MIKEY
Well, it sort of has to be one night. We have to reply. Really, they are going to be surprised we don't respond tonight. What are -

MIKA
The chances she comes back and says sell? About zero. Yes, about zero

MIKEY
We are communicating, right? Us?

MIKA
You and me? Um - yes. We are. We are communicating.

MIKEY
Look ... I don't know if there is ... if there is another offer out there. I mean, I thought I had this one ... figured out. But (looks Mika in the eyes) ... she needs to
(MORE)

MIKEY (CONT'D)
take this offer. I need to tell you something.

Mika sighs and turns the Seagrams VO bottle.

MIKA
What, what do you need to tell me.

MIKEY
I have nto sold a house in two month. This is not good for me. The tote board in the office is like a race track. I'm still in the pit area.

MIKA
Good. Good. Look. Here is my best advice. The chruch is still open. Probably until just past noon. So ... go there. Light a candle. Pray. Pray pray pray she changes her mind,.

MIKEY
Will she?

MIKA
I don't know. Really, I do not. Maybe the chance is ... 40%. The Marjean ting ... it runs deep. Friggin herb garden like some metaphor of life for that family. It was very important.

MIKEY
What do I tell the buyes?

MIKA
That there is an answer tomorrow.

MIKEY
Tomorrow.

INT. KITCHEN. THE NEXT MORNING. MIKA IS EATING A BOWL OF CORN PUFFS. MUCHING.

MIKA
We are out of Puffs. Out of Corn Puggs.

NONA
There are Cheerios. Eat thoses.

MIKA
No point. No reaon. We need more Puffs. Just get those.

NONA

How about you finish the Cheerios.

The house phone rings. Mika answers it.

MIKA

Hello?

PHONE VOICE

Its Marjean.

MIKA

Yes, who?

PHONE VOICE

Marjean

MIKA

Marjean

NONA

Marjean?

MARJEAN

Yes, Marjean. This is the the Dryki residence.

MIKA

Oh yes it is!

None comes into the kitchen.

MIKA

Its Marjean.

MARJEAN

I want to talk with Nona.

INT. DUNKIN DONUTS WHERE MIKA IS WITH HIS FIENDS.

FRIEND 1

She talked with Marjean?

MIKA

Talk is uh ... one way to put it. Argue. Scream. Swear. Is better way.

FRIEND 2

You take the offer you stupid idiot.

MIKA

We did not. I would take. I would take it today. No problem with Marjean. Who cares. Happened 30 years ago. Besides, the mint was
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

fucking terrible. They put it in everything. Salads, fruit salads, with meats, they dried it 'Try the tea.' I hated it. It was horrible. I was glad when it died. Glad.

FRIEND 1

So what the hell they say to each other.

MIKA

Oh, she try a sob story first. She say how much she need the grand daughter. She had a hip surgery and it mostly worked but she still has mobility issues. And Nona says 'Why not go to an old folks home.' Said it would be easier for her. Then, Marjean blow her top. Says she knew the offer would never be accepted and that the grand daughter was an idiot to write the letter. Nona says 'Well we agree on something at least, grand daughter is a moron.' Then Marjean says the offer is off the table. I guess the grandmother was fronting some part of it - but she thinks this will spite Nona. Nona could care less. But it is unfortunate.

FRIEND 1

Yeah, for you.

Mika searches for the crossword puzzle in the newspaper.

MIKA

Actually more for Mikey. He called her, Nona, and say 'Please try to make amends with Marjean. Please lets sell this house' She tells him to have faith. She has prayed that the house will sell. Then he calls me. He calls me. He says he is out of options. 'Mikey' I say 'Just lower the price and you will sell the house.' He says he can't do that. Now this - listen to this - very closely. He says real estate manager monitors original price versus sale price. Some formula from regional. Basically, the guys is going to get fired because he keeps listing houses at the wrong price. If this one falls below 240,
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

if the sale price is below that,
then some type of red flag. He has
had too many of these mispricings.
He gets an email weekly that warns
him what the houses have to sell
for. So has to be at least \$240.
Which I tell him - lower the price!

FRIEND 2

So what's the percentage again?

MIKA

Percentage??

FREIND 2

Yeah, like how much lower before he
gets fired.

MIKA

I have no clue. Something.
Whatever. He gets an email with a
red number that tells him, below
\$240 is a problem. He must - MUST -
keep this price on the high side or
he could lose his job. He starts
... he start crying. I tell him,
you won't lose your job just go
independent. Who cares. But he is
worried about the networking. If he
is solo, no access to the community
health plan, no leads, in a nut
shell its a ton more work. For a
very lazy lazy man.

FRIEND 1

Oh man.

Mika looks at phone.

MIKA

Hold on ... he is ... he is calling
me right now.

FREIND 2

Oh, nice!

MIKA

Hello

MIKEY

Hello, Mika.

MIKA

Yes Mikey, typically when you call a
persons cell phone you get that
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)
 person. Did you add me to the
 contacts yet?

MIKEY
 Yeah, yes. Sure!

MIKA
 Oh Mikey, again, sorry about the
 house. I tried one last time to
 speak with Nona - but - it is too
 much.

Mikey optimistically

MIKEY
 No, no, I understand. I understand.
 I want to talk about a potential
 idea for the house. We need to talk
 about it.

MIKA
 Ok, lets talk.

MIKEY
 No, in person. We need to talk in
 person. I want to talk in person.

MIKA
 Oh wow, why over the phone. Can't
 we just talk over the phone. I'm
 not doing something illegal!

MIKEY
 No, no, no, no, no, no! Oh God no.
 We just need to talk in person.

MIKA
 Yeah, you have informed me about 20
 times. Just come to the house. I
 am NOT talking about anything
 without Nona.

MIKEY
 Of course! Nona should be there.
 Today would be great.

MIKA
 Ok - then come over. Or do you want
 us to come to the office?

MIKEY
 Lets do it over lunch. Dino's Cafe.
 Lunch at noon.

MIKA

I think that will work for Nona. I just call her.

MIKEY

Ok, great. Great! Then ... lunch at noon.

MIKA

Ok, lunch at noon.

MIKEY

Bye

Mika sips coffee and looks to friends.

MIKA

You want to come to lunch? I am going to make his ass pay.

FRIEND 2

Ha!

FRIEND 1

I do like Dinos. You know if you order the pancakes or french toast they actually give you these little bottles or real maple syrup. Like the real stuff.

MIKA

Uh ... not fortunate. I had plans for this afternoon.

FRIEND 2

I wonder how much a Dunkin Donuts franchise costs.

MIKA

I was going to go the library and read the latest issue of the New Yorker. Today is the day it comes in. If I get there early enough I can beat the women who dirves the Audi who also likes to read it.

FRIEND 1

What's he want to talk about?

MIKA

I will bring him here someday. One day. You will meet Mikey. You will realize, whatever he need talk about, is never good.

FRIEND 1

And why not over the phone.

MIKA
Exactly. Never good. I hate this
shit. Why does he need to talk.

Mika looks out the window and thinks.

FRIEND 2
Maybe he's ... dying.

FRIEND 1
Yeah, that's always something people
want the 'We need to talk in
person.' Yeah, my money is on he is
dying.

MIKA
No. No. That would be too easy.

INT. BUSY DINER SETTING. WHAT ONE WOULD EXPECT IN
TYPICALLY BUSY DINER, LOTS OF PEOPLE, STAFF, AND MENAGERIE
OF ITEMS LIKE HIGHCHARIS, SWEEPERS. VERY BLUE COLLAR.
MIKA AND NONA ENTER.

HOSTESS
How many? For two?

NONA
No, no, we are mееееing someoneone.

Mikey talking to waitress and Nona see him.

NONA
Mikey

HOSTESS
Oh, you are meeting Mikey. Go on
over.

MIKA
Mikey is here often?

HOSTESS
All the time. All the time. We are
close to naming a sandwich after
him!

MIKA
(To Nona) If Mikey were to be a
luncheon meat what would he be.
Pistrami? Roast Beef? Possibly
bologne.

Mikey sipping coffee overhears the end listing of meats.

MIKEY
Bologne? Its great here. The fried
(MORE)

MIKEY (CONT'D)
bologne sandwich. Purrrr-fect. They
huse that thick bologne, the inch
thick type.

WAITRESS
Oh yes it is.

MIKA
You are our waitress, yes? I need
one thing, coffee.

WAITRESS
Oh. Oh no, no. I was just talkling
with Mikey, boyfriend and I are
thinking of getting a house.

MIKA
Really. That is great. And Mikey
gives good advice.

WAITRESS
The best. The best! Didn't know
what we could afford until Mikey ran
the numbers. Hell, I didn't even
know what a mortgage was!

Waitress moitions she needs to get going.

MIKA
Oh yes. Mikey is terrific at
numbers, knows the sweet spots. I
need to ask you, is she engaged to
the boyfriend?

MIKEY
Hmmmmm?

MIKA
The waitress, is she engaged?

MIKEY
Oh no, no I don't thinks so.

MIKA
So how will that work then, the
mortgage? How? If not engaged?
Then who owns the house.

MIKEY
Oh, thats easy.

MIKA
But how.

MIKEY
Let me explain -

NONA

Ok, sit. You can annoy Mikey and whatever waitress you like after we talk.

MIKA

So (Mike smailing) - I have Nona heer. You here. Who is our waitress - is it Mara over there? Whatever. We are all here. What do you want to talk about? What?

MIKEY

Well the house.

MIKA

No shit! Really? I tell her you have to get at least 280 for it now. I'm now convinced, higher price is the way to go!

Mikey ignores while finishing eggs benedict.

MIKEY

I think ... I think I have another buyer.

MIA

Really, you hhave another buyer? Who - no we don't need to know - what is the offer. What is the amount.

MIKEY

The good thing is, you know the person making the offer.

MIKA

Marjean? Yes, we know her Mikey.

MIKEY

No, no someone diffeent. Someone you will like.

NONA

Listen to thim. Just listen.

Mika beginning to realize situation.

MIKA

Oh shit.

WAITRESS

What I cn get for you all? Start off with drinks.

MIKA

Evidently, he has started with the entire meal already. He clearly understands the rules.

MIKEY

No no - I am going to get the Danish. The danish here is huge, its a meal onto itself. You gotta see it. It fills an entire plate.

NONA

I know! I have seen them but have never gotten it.

MIKEY

Oh, you gotta have it Nona. You gott have it. You can try the first bite.

NONA

I know aht I want. Egg white omlette, bacon on the side, coffee. Please!

MIKA

Oh, come on, Just two eggs. Flipped. The flipped ones.

MIKEY

He means over easy.

MIKA

Flipper, over easy, sunny side down. All the same. How many people say flipped? How many?

The waitress thinks. Her name is Mara from the tag..

MIKA

Mara, how many.

MARA

A few ... most say over easy. But I get what you want!

MIKA

Great. Flipped. Two. Rye bread. NO BUTTER on it. None. No butter. Please. Coffee. And how much is the orange juice. Fresh squeezed, no?

MARA

A cup is \$3.75.

MIKA

Uh - no then.

MIKEY

No, no, no, he'll get it. I am paying. I am paying. Get the jucie, its good. In fact, I'll take one too.

MIKA

Are you playing in a hockey tournament after this? Thats a lot of cards.

MARA

Oh Mikey, thanks for the time share idea.

MIKA

What? What time share?

MARA

The time share I have in Las Vegas.

MIKA

You have a time share in Las Vegas?

Mara nods - points to Mikey.

MARA

Yeah, he explained how it worked. Its a good investment.

MIKA

I am so sorry. Mara, I am Mika. And you know Mikey. So he convinced you, he had logic that made sense.

MARA

Absolutely, I am own a time share! Its going up right behind the Flamingo! I am buying it with my boyfriend.

MIKEY

Location, location, location!

MIKEY

Beautiful. Mara, thank you.

Mara is off. Mika buries head in hands.

MIKEY

I know what is happening here. I know. Should have know. Should have seen this one.

NONA

What?

MIKA

Eatery. Public eatery.

MIKA

Huh?

MIKA

Public place. You and Mikey clearly know who the buyer is. Take me to public place, pitch idea, I cannot get mad because (points around) public place.

Nona smiling

NONA

Oh, we just wanted a good lunch.

MIKA

The only thing, who is the buyer. Who.

MIKEY

Ahh yes, so back to the buyer. You know her. Irinia Polovich.

Mika smiles, then laughs.

MIKA

One more time, please.

MIKEY

Irinia. Irinia Polovich. She is -

MIKA

I know who she is. I know.

Mika looks down and says the following. In a louder voice.

MIKA

Ok, in this moment I am safe. But I am permitted one irrational moment. One, just one. I am safe but I get one. How the fuck is an unwed, mother of two from two different gentlemen going to buy a house for over 300. Note, I know the parents, who is very nice indeed, they are not independently wealthy. How the fuck is she going to pay that price.

PATRON

Hey! Language!

Mika looks up, smiles, looks to patron.

MIKA

Hey, I am sorry! I am safe here.
From this point forward I choose
peace over fear. If you knew what
was going on here - you would be on
my side.

Mika looks back to Nona and Mikey, and speaks calmly.

MIKA

Ok, how. How is she going to pay.
What is she - she works as a
receptionist at an ear, nose, and
throat doctor? How? Come on. Is
the latest guy loaded.

Mikey laughs and he puts sugar in his coffee. Mara also
serves Nona and Mika thiers.

MIKEY

I wish! Hardly. But she is doing a
join mortgage with Martin.

MIKA

Thank you. (to waitress) Who? Who?

NONA

Martin. Marting the boyfriend.
Husband to the child - we talked
about him before the baby shower.

MIKA

Oh yes, we did! And again. Come on!
But I am not unshaken as I say
this. How can they get a mortgage.
They are not even married.

MIKEY

Its 2026. Theres no morality clause
when you apply for a mortgage. Just
names!

MIKA

Thank you. Thank you. I realize
its 2026. We might forget what day
it is, but we remember the years.
But how can they get a mortgage?
Like in two months - this guy could
be onto a new woman. Move to
Memphis to take up work as a
carpenter with his new girlfriend,
see the kid once a year when he is
back in town to visit.

Mika looks out the window.

NONA

No, not Martin. He is a good guy!
He is.

MIKA

Ya know, I think, in Scandanavia, I think Sweden, its rather common for the man and woman to have a family but not formally get married. Ever. I think. Did I see that on the PBS? I forget where. They must have a name for it, like a nice name. Not common law or whatever we call it here. So, they are that then. Ok. Whatever the Se

Mika then pulss out his phone.

MIKEY

Well ... whatever the case, they qualified for a \$200K mortgage. Jointly. They got approved on Friday.

Mika keeps looking at phone.

NONA

Mika, what are you doing.

MIKA

It is. It is a thing. Actually, its quite common! Its called sambo. What a name. Oh this is great. Great. In Sweden. When the man and woman are not married but are romantically involved, start a family. It quite common. There laws for it and everything. So, I was wrong. Irinia and Martin are not common law, they are sambo. Its very Scandinavian.

NONA

Yes, very Scandanavian. Forward thinking.

Mika looks up.

MIKA

Ok - so - we are done right? You (points to Mikey) need it to be at least \$240 - house is definitely worth that. They can only pony up \$200K. So, end of dicussion. Right. Right? Nona, you do not know this but he needs the house to
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)
 sell for at least 240 or he is done
 and Empire. Done.

Mika looks at them both. Nona and Mikey are silent.

MIKA
 But ... you do know that. Oh fuck.
 That wasn't the bad part. Not even
 the bad part!

PATRON
 Hey!

MIKA
 Sorry, sorry! I am calm and
 centered. I am at peace with what
 is happening. I am not this stress,
 I am its awareness. But what ...
 what is the idea? I still do not
 understand.

NONA
 They don't have to make up the
 difference. We give it with the
 commission.

She sips her coffee.

MIKA
 What? What does that mean?

NONA
 We increase the percentage that
 Mikey gets to get him to \$240.

MIKA
 So ... we get less. We only get
 \$200. And we give a commission at a
 rate as though it were \$240.

NONA
 Yes.

MIKEY
 Yes!

MIKA
 And this sells the house. Right?
 This sells the house. Right?

NONA
 Yes.

MIKA
 Why do we do this? You realize - we
 (MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

had an offer. An actual offer for 280K. A great offer. And now we lose 80K - more than that with this commission nonsense. Why do we do this. No - no. No, just reduce the price to 250 and sell it that way. It will sell.

NONA

We are doing this because we are kind people. Because we help people. Mikey needs a sale. Irinia needs a house. A big house with children in the space. They need room. And we can do this.

MIKA

They why not list it at 250K and Irinia can go to her momma and papa and ask for the money.

NONA

No, not. We will not do this.

MIKEY

And 200 K is still a great price. For that amount I know many timeshares in Ft. Lauderdale right on the water.

MIKA

You - you. We are not getting a timeshare. I know where that leads. I hear the commercials 'Do you own a timeshare and want to get out.' No, no!

Mikey shrugs and go backs to eating.

MIKEY

They are not that bad. Its almost like playing cards when you have a bunch of them. Its fun! It gives you so many options of where to go..

MIKA

Yes, just like bridge or pinocle. Great. So ... we are out over 90 K. And Irinia and ... Martin, is it Martin. They get a house.

NONA

Exactly!

MIKA

Well, this is your house. Your money. You can do what you want. I am at peace. But - can I say one thing. Just one?

NONA

Yes. One.

Mika points to Mikey

MIKA

This, this is your fault. Your fault! I tell you the house should have been lower. Lower! We could have set the initial price at 250, gotten an offer and been out of this deal. Out. Even if it sold for 235 that is a lot more money!

NONA

Well, water under the bridge.

MIKA

Yes, under the bridge.

MIKEY

Well, this is great news. I am glad we have resolution. Really glad. Let's talk next steps.

MIKA

Yes, resolution. The next steps are - they close. Just find a closing date. Find a closing date.

Waitress arrives with the food. She places in front of Nona and Mika

MARA

Ok, eggs, over easy. Or flipped.

MIKA

Thank you.

MARA

And an egg white omlette. Which is a great choice. This one is my favorite! Not enough people order it in my opinion.

NONA

Thank you!

MIKA

Mara, one thing. Just quickly
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)
before I forget. You have so many
people to take care of.

MARA
Sure. Sure!

MIKA
I cannot help but remember. You
said you bought the timeshare with
your boyfriend. This is a very
European thing to do. I am from
Europe. Buying a house, starting a
family, maybe, I do know your
situation of course. But doing
that. It reminded me of Europe. In
fact, in Sweden, Sweden, it is
called Suomo. I like it, I think it
is grea.

Mara smiles. Turns to face Mika.

MARA
Thank you. Thank you! My mother
thinks I'm crazy to do this. But,
its nots. Its like, refined.
European. What is it called.

MIKA
Suomo. Suomo. Just, ask ChatGPT.
Very European. It reminded of being
in the old country.

MARA
I am going to tell my mother this.
Again, thank you! Its right behind
the Flamingo too!

Mara walks away.

NONA
You are an asshole.

MIKA
I am just making people happy. I
like to spread joy. I am supported
by the wisdom of the universe.

Mieky looks to ask Mika a question. Shakes his head and
dives into the Danish.

MIKEY
Oh, Nona you have to try it.

INT. LIBRARY. MIKA STES AT A SEAT READING THE NEW YORK
TIMES. ACROSS FROM HIS A PETITE OLDER WOMAN IMPECCABLY

DRESSED PAGES THROUGH A NEW YORKER. MIKA'S PHONE RINGS.

MIKA

Yes. What is it.

NONA

Are you at the library.

MIKA

Yes, you know that I am.

NONA

Ok, I thought you would be. I have good news.

MIKA

Martina and Irinia cannot buy the house.

The older looks and shakes head. Mika waves her off as he gets up to go outside.

NONA

No, no, not that. Not at all. Rather, we have a dinner party.

MIKA

I thought you said this was good news.

NONA

With Martin and Irinia.

Mika is silent

NONA

Hello?

MIKA

Waiting. I am waiting for the good news.

NONA

Come on. This is a good thing! We can see them, and she wants us to meet Susanna.

MIKA

Why must we have dinner with them. Can't we just sell them the house. Why not do it after they have the house.

NONA

No, no. That is a house warming part. That will happen too!

MIKA

We are not getting them a gift for that. We are not.

NONA

Yes, we are! We are. Its on Tuesday.

MIKA

Choice?

NONA

None. You are going.

MIKA

Ok, we are going. At least the child has a decent name. She must be close to having the other child.

NONA

She is eight months. Eight.

MIKA

This new baby is not going to interfere with the closing?

NONA

I need to you pick-up a champagne on the way home.

MIKA

Oh come on, for the dinner on Tuesday? Really?

NONA

Yes, Chazs is open. I like that processo they had, the one with the blue lable.

MIKA

But processo is not champagne, Nona. Is not champagne!

NONA

It is sparkling, that is all that matters. When will you leave the library?

MIKA

I don't know.

Mika peers into the window, the older woman is now talking with a friend.

MIKA

Like in a half hour. You know the dinner is not until Tuesday.

NONA
Just get the damn prosecco.

MIKA
Ok, ok.

Mika hangs up and heads back in. He goes to where the older woman sits and picks up the New Yorker from the table next to her.

OLDER WOMAN
Excuse me!

MIKA
What?

OLDER WOMAN
Excuse me! I am not done with that.

MIKA
It appears yes, you are. You are not reading it, you are having conversation.

OLDER WOMAN
I can do both. Thank you.

She reaches and grabs the magazine and goes back to talking. Mika points.

MIKA
Next week next week!

This time the older woman waves off Mika and goes back to her pleasant conversation. Mika heads to the circulation desk.

MIKA
Did the book come in?

LIBRARIAN
It takes one week for inter library loan.

MIKA
Exactly. I see it on the shelf there.

Shelf shows a copy of Deepak Chopra book. Librarian goes to get it.

LIBRARIAN
This is a new release, so you only get 1 week.

MIKA
Fine, it is perfectly fine.

INT. COFFEE SHOP

Mika sits with his friends and talks. A larger crowd.

FRIEND 1

So you gave them 40K.

MIKA

No, I gave them no money.

FRIEND 1

No, no, no. You did. You gifted them 40K at least. You could of sold for that. Right?

MIKA

Oh yeah. In that sense, correct. Bank of Mika give them 40 K. Happy wife, happy life.

He sips his coffee.

FRIEND 2

Wow. My first house ... in last lent us 10 K. Ok, just to help us out. Thats it. Ya know, a gift. Before all this shit got tracked by the government. Never heard the end of it. NEVER heard the end of it. Like everything. We paid them back too. Paid them back.

MIKA

With interst.

FRIEND 2

No - like two years later I gave them 5 K. And I thought for sure they would say 'Oh forget the rest, merry Christmas.' Old man was sittin in his chair watching TV. Didn't even look up when I gave my mother-in-law the check. Just shouted 'When do we see the other 5 thousand. When.' Cheap ass bastard. His own daughter, not desire to help her out.

FRIEND 1

Wow.

FRIEND 2

They brought it up all the time. Whenever we did anything that required a dime of money that asshole would say 'But you guys
(MORE)

FRIEND 2 (CONT'D)
 might need the hlp. You know, the
 house.' Worse thing I ever did.

FRIEND 1
 Why did you need just 10 K?

FRIEND 2
 We didn't really. We had the money
 to cover everything. It just would
 have been like an extra \$100 a month
 because our downpayment was low.
 Some shit like that. So I said
 'Yeah, we'll do this.' So stupid.
 It still burns me.

MIKA
 Yeah, well, they have money to burn
 on stupid stuff.

FRIEND 2
 Like what?

MIKA
 Grooming. Dog grooming. I happen
 to know that Irinia has Shi Tzu.
 She takes it every three weeks to
 get groomed. Every three weeks.
 Groomed, bath, nails grimmied. \$200.
 \$200! You add that up ... 52
 divided by 3 ... that is \$2,800
 right there. But I have to give
 them money. I have to give to them.
 Tonight I will see them for dinner.

FRIEND 1
 Good luck with that!

MIKA
 The 'thank you' is when house is
 sold. That will be the thank you,
 when I no longer have to worry about
 this stuff.

Philosopher is in other both. He chimes in.

PHILOSOPHER
 Every experience, good or bad,
 evolves the soul.

MIKA
 Oh oh ... thank you Randy.
 Thank you.

FIREND 2
 Wait a shit zu, those things are
 small. Like, tiny. \$200.

FRIEND

I would do it for half the price.

MIKA

Randy. Randy. Please tell me how my soul will evolve because of all of this. My time on this planet is limited, please, tell me.

PHILOSOPHER

Its for you to find out.

MIKA

Great, great. Hey (to the boy), what did you learn this morning.

Bou reads and with looking at Mika answers.

BOY

Federalist papers. We learned about them this morning. I'm reading one right now.

MIKA

Great, I am sure they are important. American educations is definitely the best.

Randy rises.

PHILOSOPHER

Their important. Without them we would not have this nation.

MIKA

Good, well, I'll read them for sure. If you all leave know you won't know what Nona is making for the dessert tonight.

PHILOSOPHER

We are fine. I'm sure we'll hear what it is later on.

Mika thinks.

MIKA

You are philosopher. Right? So, have I made any mistakes?

PHILOSOPHER

Mistakes? Yes, a lot. The classic ones. Uh 'Accounts make good friends'.

MIKA

What does that mean?

PHILOSOPHER

It means when money is involved,
make expectations clear.

Mika looks at coffee and thinks again.

MIKA

Hmmm ... then I did it right. I
made it clear that I thoughts
anything with money and Mikey was a
bad idea. Would never lead anywhere
good.

EXT. OF HOUSE. NONA AND MIKA KNOCK ON A FRONT DOOR.
IRINIA OPENS THE DOOR. IN THE BACKGROUND ARE MIKEY AND
MARTIN. TWO TEENAGE BOYS FIGHT OVER A GAME CONOLE.

NONA

Irinia! You look amazing! One more
month, one more month.

IRINIA

I know. I know! Susanna is so
excited. She keeps asking when she
is going to have a baby sister. One
month! Probably earlier, I can just
feel it.

MIKA

Hello Irinia. And Mikey - why are
you here?

IRINIA

Hello uncle Mika. Mikey wanted to
be here to celebrate.

MIKA

Indeed, let us celebrate. Yes,
celebrate.

IRINIA

Come, Nona, come and look at the
nursery vision board. Look at what
we are planning. Martin tooks pics
of the bedrooms.. Martin wants to
paint it this shade of pink, it is
beautiful. Come come.

NONA

I have this cake, where should I put
it.

IRINIA

In the kitchen. Right here.
Martin, introduce yourself. Guests!

Martin sits on a couch watching TV. A bowling tournament is on. He simply turns and makes eye contact.

MARTIN

Heeeeey! Hey fella! Great to meet ya. Mika, right?

MIKA

Yes, Mika. It is good to meet you.

MARTIN

Hey, first, thank you for helping out with the house. Much appreciated.

Martin tips his beer to Mika.

MARTIN

Make yourself at home! There's beer in the fridge. You like bowling?

MIKA

Yes. I have not bowled in many years. But I like it.

MARTIN

Head on over to that fridge and grab a cold one. And then come on back. Tatum, get up, let Mika sit there.

One of the teenage boys sulks away. Mika heads to the kitchen. From the background.

MARTIN

There is Miller Lite and Coors Lite. The Coors is for Irinia.

MIKA

Uh ... isn't she pregnant.

MARTIN

Exactly. That's why there's Coors Light. Hard liquors in the dining room.

Mika opens the fridge and pulls out a Miller Lite. He opens the bottle and looks around. There is no evidence of a dinner being prepared. He returns to the living room.

MIKA

This is, quaint. Its nice.

MARTIN

Thanks! All Irinia. All Irinia.

MIKA

I do not see a dinner. Are we going out?

MARTIN

What? Oh, no, no. We ordered Chinese. I hope you like it.

MIKA

Yeah, sure.

MARTIN

We got it all. The General Tsaos. Sesame chicken. Some type of pork and broccoli stuff. Both types of rice.

MIKA

That sounds splendid. Splendid.

MARTIN

Yeah, we do it like twice a week. There's a Chinese place off Brompton thats good. Avoid the one on Lajoie. Avoid! Right Tatum.

Tatum plays his gaming console and gives his father the finger.

MARTIN

We think he got food poisoning there. We think.

MIKA

Yes, its always hard to figure out where. I saw on the PBS that you think its the last thing you ate but typically is not.

MARTIN

Yeah, for sure. For sure. We setup the dinner homestyle. So, you get what you want. Unless Tatum and Kenny want it, then its a fight.

MIKA

Yep, a fight. So, I heard you had pictures of the house. When did you walk through it?

MARTIN

Oh, jsut the ones from online. We just figured out stuff from that. The home inspection will be later. Its a nice house, the layout is great but all the stuff is so outdate.

TATUM
Like the pink bathroom.

MIKA
You, you are Tatum, correct.

TATUM
Yes I am .

MIKA
Was very populat back int eh 1970s.
You choose pinks, browns, avacado
green. Very popular.

Mika thinks.

MIKA
What home inspection happens later?

MARTIN
Oh, for the house. Gotta have a
home inspection. You know, you
gotta protect yourself, know what
you are getting into.

MIKA
Of course, of course!

TATUM
Dad, he's two blocks away.

MARTIN
Ok, ok.

TATUM
Dad, two blocks. Well, almost one
now.

MARTIN
Ok! I'll set the damn table!

Mika rises with Martin.

MIKA
Need to see what Nona is up to!

Mika wanders down hallway to another room. Its the
bedroom of Susanna. There a large table is present and
the the three, Nona, Mikey, and Irinia sit or stand. A

IRINIA
And that is where the rocking chair
will go. Right there, by the
window.

NONA

I always liked having it by the window. When I nursed I could look out the window. Then later the babies would always look at the leaves moved by the wind. It was nice. That is a good spot.

IRINIA

Oh you nursed too!

NONA

Yes, it was right at the point where they switched back from doing it to not doing it. And I need to tell you about these nut allergies -

MIKA

Yes, great. Great. Nona, I need to ask you about the champagne, the food is on the way.

NONA

You just open it.

MIKA

Yes, but how.

Nona slowly looks to Mika as though he has lost his mind.

NONA

Its a cork. Pretty simple.

MIKA

But then what glasses.

IRINIA

Oh, there are champagne glasses by the microwave. I'll get them!

MIKEY

No, you point where and I will get them down! We can't have you doing anything unnecessary.

IRINIA

Friggin pregnancy - I can't drink.

NONA

Don't worry I made the cake!

MIKA

What about the Coors?

Irinia rolls here eyes.

IRINIA

Those are for Martin's mom.

Irinia and Mikey leave.

MIKEY

I think you can definitely use that shower as a tub. I think it has a lip on the front

NONA

They can certainly use that shower to wash the baby. I believe, no, I know my mom used to do that.

MIKA

Home inspection.

NONA

Yes, what about it.

MIKA

Home inspeciton?

NONA

What?

MIKA

Hello, they are going to have a home inspection!

NONA

Be quiet! Yes, they are. I knew about that.

MIKA

Are you crazy. Are we crazy! Home inspection! Do the realize the price they are getting this for!

Mikey reneters and senese the tension

MIKEY

Whats going on?

MIKA

Where is Irinia?

MIKEY

Setting the table with Martin. He couldn't find -

MIKA

He couldn't find anything if he needed. We need to talk. What is this home inspection shit? Home inpsection?

MIKEY

Yeah, I told them to do it.

MIKA

What. What!

MIKEY

As their real estate agent I have a duty to ensure their best interste.

MIKA

Oh great. Great. Of course. You are their agent as well. Right? Enough. Enough.

Mika then pulls back. Inhales an exhales. Holds up index finger.

MIKA

I release what I cannot control. But ... one thing I do control. Not dime less. Not dime. I swear to you Mikey, if Martin and Irinia want more off, want repairs, deal is off.

NONA

The deal won't be off. Let them do the inspection. Its a good think. Mikey - they even have a swatch for the curtains look.

MIKEY

Oh wow, they got that at the Hobby Lobby, right? Oh, forest animals!

MIKA

I mean it, if they come back with requests, deal is off. Nona, is off, understood.

MIKEY

Of course, of course, I will talk to them.

Mika looks at the vision space.

MIKA

It actually looks nice. I might try to update something else, first. But nursery is important.

MIKEY

The most important. I spent weeks getting ours into shape. Owen and Fisher used the same one. Fisher did not like having to leave. We

(MORE)

MIKEY (CONT'D)
had to tell him that his baby
brother needed it. Oh the crying it
went on for days. One morning we
found him back in the nursery
sleeping on the floor.

MIKA
Yes, such difficulties.

All are around the dining room table, finishing the
Chinese food.

MARTIN
I do tile work. I started out in
general construction but, the tile
stuff suited me. I was - I am -
good at it.

MIKA
Yes, tile work. Is certainly needed
for the pink tiles. No?

MARTIN
Oh yeah, those will be the first
things to go. I can knock that out
in like a week. I need to poke
around tomorrow and see what else is
up. Sometimes its all rotten behind
the tiles.

The children dive in for more Chinese. And it is clear
the family is eating off of Chinet type plates.

MIKA
Oh - tomorrow? What happens
tomorrow.

MARTIN
The home inspection. At 3PM.

NONA
Susanna, you can choose the bedroom
you want. Mine was the one on the
corner. I liked it because it had
windows facing two ways. I would
recommend that.

MARTIN
Oh, thats a whole thing! Kids want
to see it and then probably fight
over it.

IRINIA
I think Susanna will get her choice.
Ladies first..

MIKA

The home inspeciton is ... tomorrow?

MARTIN

Oh yeah, it works for my schedule.
I have a job in Eaton - I can get it
done by 1PM and then swing over to
the house.

MIKA

Good, good. I will be there too!

MIKEY

Oh ... you don't have to go. I can
take care of it! Technically the
homeowner should not be there for
the inspection.

MIKA

Nonsense, we are familiy. I know a
lot about the house. I can answer
quesitons. Point out things. And
also, technically, agent should not
represent both. Uirinia and Martin
should have their own agent to
advocate.

MIKEY

Its fine, its fine! You should be
there.

MARTIN

I'd like that! I'd like that if you
were there. Always good to have
someone who can explain.

MIKA

Absolutely.

NONA

Well, let us clear and bring in the
cake!

As Nona gets up so does Mika.

MIKA

Yes, let us help you and clear.
Martin, you were right, you would
never know these plates are
disposable.

MARTIN

Ain't it something! Its like ... it
looks exactly like real plates.
Just like my moms. Its so neat.
Hey - is that coffee ready?

EXT. HOME INSPECTION OUTSIDE OF STRAWBERRY BLONDE. THEY STAND BY MIKEY'S BMW. TWO CUPS OF DUNKIN DONUTS COFFEE SIT ON TOP OF THE ROOF. MIKEY LOOKS AT PHONE.

MIKEY

You know anyone interested in a condo. Two bedrooms, 1.5 baths.

MIKA

Where.

MIKEY

Kensington and Brayson.

MIKA

No, I don't. I'm in my 70s. Most of the people I know are more concerned with a smaller plot of real estate. Your listing?

MIKEY

Yeay, Brian just gave it to me. After I got this one on the books, he fed me this condo. Is that a chez sofa. Is that what they call those things.

MIKA

That is great. So happy this house is leading to so many good things for you.

A massive duely pickup truck pulls up. Out steps Martin in a satin jacket with Martins Tiling and Carpentry. The two snot nosed bous from the dinner exit exceiteldly. They immediately tera into the house at top speed. Mika watches as their images pass through windows. Irinia also piles out of the truck, though labriously. Martin offers no help as he checks his phone. The daughter Susanna comes to her mothers rescue.

MARTIN

I'll tell you the first problem. That roof. I know roofs. Its not long for the world.

IRINIA

Oh. That doesn't sound good. How much will it cost.

MARTIN

Oh ... 20 thousand. Probably. I thought it might not be good from the pictures. Yeah, its got maybe one ... two years left.

Mika exasperated. Goes to speak to Mikey. But first.

MIKEY

Ok, walk the exterior first! Noe
 antyhing you have a problem with!
 Note it all!

Irinia and Martin wave and start their walk.

MIKA

What the - Mikey - what the hell are
 you saying.

MIKEY

Mika, I have a duty to represent
 the folks. Just know that whatever
 they identify, we'll have to deal
 with it.

MIKA

Jesus Christ. Yes, deal with it.
 Where the hell did those animal kids
 go.

MIKEY

Oh, they went in the house with
 Irinia.

MIKA

Mikey - Irinia is right there.
 Those fucking kids ...

Mika storms off to the house. Shouts to Mikey.

MIKA

What are their names? Childern?
 Names?

MAIKEY

Oh, Tatum and Ken! Great kids!
 Probably figuring out which bedroom
 to take. Amazing kids. The one is
 in Fisher's travel leagure, he has
 real -

Mika simply turns and heds into the house. Irinia and
 Martin look at a white plumbing pipe coming out of the
 ground. Mika shouts over.

MIKA

Its a bubbler system. For
 draininge!

MARTIN

I know! Why would they have a clean
 out here?

Mika ignores the question and heads into the house. Tatum is pressing the ice dispenser and watches as cubes fall to the ground. From the living room another sound is heard.

MIKA

You, you, I know you. Tatum right?

TATUM

Yeah, why?

MIKA

Get out of house and to your father.
Now! Stay with her the entire time
you are here. GET OUT!

Tatum presses the ice cube dispenser one more time and then leaves.

TATUM

Can you clean that up!

Mika then heads to the living room. The child is by the fireplace, poker in hand. He is smashing at a grill trying to pry it off.

MIKA

Hey, stop! Why you do that! Stop
now.

KENNETH

Why?

MIKA

Why? WHY! Because I fucking said
said so. Why you do that!

KENNETH

Because this is our house and I
don't like this.

MIKA

Your house ... your house! I own
this house. I own it.

KENNETH

Its ours!

MIKA

Get out now. Now. Or I'll wrap
that goddamn poker round your neck.

Mika grabs poker out of the boys hand. Kenneth runs out of the house screaming. As he hears out of house the two boys are in the backyard messing in the bushes.

IRINIA

Oh, sorry Mika! Sorry. Boys ...
don't worry they'll stay with us.

MIKA

Oh, I understand! I understand!
Had two boys. Just making sure they
were safe in there.

MARTIN

I saw that staif case the railing!
Tell me our guys are going to turn
that into some rock climbing thing!

MIKA

Yep. Sports. I am to going to wait
in the garden! Enjoy the walk
through!

Mika heads to the garden area where the boys push down
bushes to get to the fence.

MIKA

You two, get out of here. Stay
outside. Go in with parents only to
the house. Parents only!

The boys rush off while Mika sits inthe garden area. His
phone rings.

MIKA

Hi Nona

NONA

Hi, how is it going?

MIKA

Oh, he is saying things that need be
fixed. Whatever. They have such
lovely boys!

NONA

I know! I just love the idea of
children in that house again! My mom
would have loved it.

MIKA

I am in the garden. In the back.
Its beautiful. It really is. With
weed tarp and perennniasl - it very
nice.

NONA

I know. I know. Mom loved to sit
back there.

MIKA

She would sit back here by the hour.
And listen to those cds. Who was
it? Who - the one she liked best?

NONA

What?

MIKA

The cd, the cd player. The disks
she really liked. Remember?

NONA

Oh, yes, Miss Judy. Miss Judy.
Judy Collins. Yes she loved her
very much.

MIKA

You know, I liked coming to your
mother's house. Very much. My
parent's house, just ok. But I
liked it here.

NONA

I did too. Be sure to do one thing.
There are small flower pots closet
to the fence. They have rosemary.
Take those for me.

MIKA

Yes, of course.

Mika collects the pots and continues to sit. Time passes
and Mika walks back. He stands behind Mika but does not
face him.

MIKEY

So, the liked the house. Only a few
things. Just minor.

MIKA

House is old. There will be things
of course.

MIKEY

So, the roof is not good. We went
in the attic and -

MIKA

Stop. I know what they want. And
thinking, hosue at 210 K still need
renovations. If they look, they
will say, needs furncace, needs
roof, needs kitchern Needs ...
everything. So much work. But you
know, I know, 210K it is worth every
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

penny. So I will tell you, what do you get for free in life. Little. Nothing. Here is what they get for free - including the 70 thousand because you decided to read a letter. Get 5 thousand more off. Is furance, is stove is something, not othing. New price is 205 K.

MIKEY

Thats perfect. They wanted at least 10 - half say point. Mika, you be a real estate agent.

MIKA

Yes, of course.

Mikey walks off with the news for Irinia and Martin. Mika calls Nona.

MIKA

Good news, I did something nie. Kind. Deal will close, Mikey makes commission, Irinia gets a house.

NONA

Oh, that is wonderful! Oh that is great. See, Mika, you did a good job. Let me talk with Mikey.

MIKEY

He will be here in a minute. He is talking with them. Do you need me to pick up anything on the way home? I think we are out of pickles. For the sandwiches.

NONA

Yes pickles, and some type of pasta. Whatever you think is best.

Mikey is back.

MIKEY

Smooth deal done! Done!

MIKA

Great. Nona wants to talk.

Mika hands phone over the shoulder. Mikey and Nona talk.

MIKEY

Yeah, its great! Oh the kids loved it.

While they talk Mika looks at coffee and garden itself. A phone gently comes over his right sholder as Mikey hands it back. Still not facing Mikey.

MIKEY

Nona said goodbye. Well all you have to do now is sign off on the papers. We can do that here.

MIKA

Yes, we pay a lot out of pocket. Now ... it is 75K. 75 times 8 ... that is 11K. We take one third of that. Say 3K. That ... Mikey .. that is how much you are going to remove from your commission.

MIKEY

Ohhhh ..., I was counting on the whole thing.

Mika holds up one finger.

MIKA

What you learn the hard way beccomes the grace you carry forward.

MIKEY

What?

MIKA

Lets go sign the papers.

INT. COFFEE SHOP WITH MIKA IN LINE.

MIKA

One cream. One cream! Every day its the same. The same! You have been, Robert, you have been working here since August of last year. Every day I order the same thing, small coffee with one cream. How can you not remember that? Do you not know me, remember me?

Robert gives a blank stare

MIKA

Come on, I give the exact change pretty much everyday. That way I know when you are screwing us on the prices.

MANGAER

I'll talk to him Mika. We know, its one cream.

MIKA

Samantha, come on! Has been here 9 months and does not know me? Every day?

Samantha makes the coffee.

SAMANTHA (MANAGER)

I know, I know.

MIKA

Sam, you worry about the future when you see kids like this? Sam? Do you?

SAMANTHA

I do. I do to. Robert - a half dozen means six. It means six. (under her breath) Goddamit. I'm coming ...

Sam storms over to the donut case. Mika heads to his friends. Rubs hands together a la LeBron James.

MIKA

Its closing day. Closing day!

FRIEND 1

Oh, nice. Finally.

FRIENT 2

Yeah, finally we can stop hearing about this shit.

MIKA

Oh come on, you like! Magical day, closes at 1PM. Call from attorney. Check in bank. Done with house. Done with Mikey, Irinia, all of it.

FRIEND 2

Took goddamn long enough. This guy - he was able to RV coast to coast. Like coast to coast in the time it took you to close on this house.

MIKA

How was it?

FRIEND 3

Oh it was amazing. Amazing. RV's on route 66. Stayed at military bases. The highlight - Grand Canyon. That thing is huge.

FRIEND 2

Really, I never knew!

MIKA

Did you have a car? Did you trailer
a car?

FREIND 3

Oh yeah. The bronco. Put that
sucker on it and towed all the way
from St. Louis to Los Angeles. Oh,
best trip ever.

FRIEND 1

How do you do it? I mean, I would
be terrified to change lanes with
it. Can you even see it?

FRIEND 3

They have a camera mount so ... you
can sort of see whats going on. But
we were in Arizona, and, it was like
clear behind me to merge, so I do.
But this guy in the outer lane
merges and the same time. The EXACT
same time. I nearly took him out.

FRIEND 1

You give way?

FRIEND 3

Hello no! He goes crazy and starts
laying on the horn. My wife was
like "Oh my God we are going to hit
him." Yeah, backed down.

FRIEND 1

Nice!

MIKA

I could not imagine being in RV with
Nona for ... weeks. I would not
want to imagine it.

Mika looks at phone while friends talk about trip. It is
a call from MIKEY

MIKA

Hey, how are you.

MIKEY

Good. I think. I'm here.

MIKA

Where at the closing? At the clerks
office? That's not for another two
hours.

MIKEY

No, I'm here.

MIKA

WHERE!

MIKEY

At the coffee shop.

MIKA

Why the hell are you here? Just focus on the closing. Where are you.

MIKEY

Out front. Nona said you would be here. We need to talk about the closing ... it might not happen.

MIKA

Might not happen? Might?

MIKEY

Probably won't happen.

Mika hangs up phone. Aggitate he rises and makes contact with Mikey outside. Mikey sees Mika smiles and waves.

MIKA

Wait here. That. That is Mikey. I need to talk with him. The friends look. Two of them wave and Mikey waves back.

FRIEND 2

Mikey! Theres the BMW. Mika, it looks like a fine car.

MIKA

Is a lease. Is not his car. I need to talk to him.

MIKA storms outside while the frineds continue to talk,.

FRINED 3

No, no, I take it back. The best part of the tripe, Canyon de Chelly. That was it. Canyon de Chelly. You know they have Navajo communities there. They live, not all of them, but some in these hogans. Like this type of structure that has been around for I dunno, over a 1000 years.

FRIEND 2

Hogans.

FRIEND 3

Yeah, exactly. But the thing is this. They have provably lived there, like these communities and families for over a 1000 years. Then I get to thinking. AND here is where I wished my grandkids where there.

Friend 3 sips coffee. Outside we see an agitated Mika essentially scream at Mikey.

FRIEND 3

Ya know, we talk about birth of our contry, and go west young man, and all that stuff. Like, its what we teach our kids. All of em. And then we talk about how the east coast is the historic, old, first settlements in the country. And its complete bullshit. Complete bullshit.

FRIEND 1

How so?

FRIEND 3

Come on. These are the first settlements, like right here. The Indians were not just nomadic or living in the woods or whatever. They had these settlements. The west, the west coast, that really is the old world for native Americans. Like, its where they first settled and you have communities over a 1000 years old - and what - we are at 250 years for the U.S.

FRIEND 1

You gonna contact the school system.

FRIEND 3

Screw you! But I am gonna tell my grandkids and they are going on trip with me there. With whatever time I have left.

Outside we see Mika and Mikey arguing more. Mika motions for Mikey to come inside. They both head in.

FRIEND 3

Went to a really neat National Park near Santa Fe, Bandelier, that was a beautiful park.

FRIEND 2

Santa Fe, is that where Gene Hackman died?

FRIEND 1

Hackman. Hoosier. Now theres's a movie. I had my son watch it to understand how to prepare for games. Mentally.

Mika and Mikey enter.

MIKA

I have to call Nona. Guys, this is Mikey. Talk.

FRIENDS IN TOTO

Hey Mikey! Mikey! We have heard so much about you!

MIKEY

Oh that great! Hey, I am real estate. Let me give you my card -

MIKA

They know who you are. Any real estate desires of the like - I direct them to you. Hello, Nona? I need your advice.

FRIEND 3

What happened.

Mikey sits with the others.

MIKEY

Well, its Martin. Do you guys know Martin?

FRIEND 2

Yeah, the dude buying the house.

MIKEY

Ahh, so you do know Martin. How much has Mika told you.

FRIEND 1

Ya know, just like a little. Fill us in please.

MIKEY

Well, Martin was working a job last night. And he was framining in a closet.

MIKA

He lays tile! Idiot was doing a
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

side job! No no, Mikey is here, I just ... I needed to say that, there was inaccuracy ...

MIKEY

He was working with a oscillating saw cutting dry wall ... and cut his finger pretty badly. I had to Google oscillating saw - I never knew.

FIREND 2

How bad. He lost a finger or something.

MIKEY

No, no, he lost a fingernail.

FRIEND 3

Fingernail? Like it got smashed.

MIKEY

No, it got cut off. It got sliced off.

FRIEND 3

Oh come on, no way.

MIKEY

Oh he did, its bad. Its bad! He Tik Tok'd after it happened. Look -

Mikey shows his phone to the friends. All look in disgust.

FRIENDS

Oh come on, why did you have to show us that! Come on man.

MIKEY

Well, they were able to stitch the fingernail cap back on. But he's definitely going to lose the nail. I think it 28 stitches.

MIKA

Stop talking to them. Look at me. Nona is still ok to watch Susanna when she gets off bus. And she can take care of Angela as well. So, what is problem>

MIKEY

So, we need him at the closing. We need him.

MIKA

You need him physically there?

MIKEY

Yes, his name is on the mortgage -
he has to be there. In person.

MIKA

So we take him. Hell, I go to. We
take him. He just signs with an X -
who cares. Why is this a big deal.

MIKEY

Iriinia. Irinia. She says he can't
go. He is out of it. He is on
medication, and is sluggish, won't
get out of bed.

MIKA

So, just do the closing tomorrow
then.

MIKEY

It doesn't work that way. We have to
get back on the master schedule.

MIKA

So ...

MIKEY

So, we wait another three weeks.

MIKA

Fuck no. It happens today then!

MIKEY

And if we miss today, the mortgage
offer might expire during that time
and he has to reapply-

MIKA

Stop. Stop, stop, stop. It happens.
Why do you people drag me into this
shit.

MIKEY

We didn't plan to do this.

MIKA

Let's go to Irinias. Nona will be
there in the hour.

Mika starts to head to door but Mikey proceeds into the
line of customers.

MIKA

Mikey, now, what are you doing?

MIKEY
I getting ... I need. I need
breakfast.

MIKA
What, what you crazy let's go.

MIKEY
You don't understand, without
breakfast I am not funcitoning well.
Um ...

ROBERT
White, wheat, or rye.

MIKEY
Is the rye seeded?

ROBERT
Is the rye wht?

MIKEY
Seeded?

ROBERT
What.

MIKA
Oh Jesus Christ. Just give him the
white. The white. You get white.
Samantha, Sam!

SAM
What?

MIKA
Please, make sandwich for my friend.
We are in rush. And he ... must
eat. Robert you are great kid,
bound for great things. You take a
century to make sandwich.

SAM
I will make it. Calm down. Calm
down!

INT. DRIVING IN BMW

Mikey is driving and holding sandwich. Mika sits in the
passenger seat looking out window.

MIKEY
I wish I would have known if it were
seeded or not. Ya know, I like a
seeded rye.

Mika says sarcastically

MIKA

Oh, don't worry. It was not seeded.
Not seeded. Hopefully the wheat
would not be choice two.

MIKEY

It could have been, in the moment.

MIKA

Where is your phone.

MIKEY

Why?

MIKA

I call Irinia. Have to call her. To
reassure.

MIKEY

Its here. Here. Wait, let me just
voice call her. Siri, call Irinia.

Phone rings.

IRINIA

Hello. Mikey?

MIKA

Nina, its Mika, I am with Mikey.
How is Martin. Terrible thing that
happened, how is he.

IRINIA

Oh Mika, Mika, not good. Not good.
He slept all night but now he's just
moaning in bed.

MIKEY

So, do you think he might be - I
don't know - better - a little
better by noon for the closing?

IRINIA

Oh Mikey, Mika, I don't know. I
think we have to cancel the closing
- right? I don't know - can we do
it?

MIKEY

Well, I can bring you there. And
Mika is here to help to. We can
take the beamer.

MIKA

And Nona will still watch Angela and
Susanna when she is off the bus. By
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

the way, I love the babies name. I truly do.

IRINIA

Oh thank you. Thank you! It was Martin's grandmothers name. I wish he hadn't done this. I told him to just stay home. But he's trying to do all these side jobs because he's worried about the mortagage.

MIKA

Yeah well, he's got 30 years to worry about it. Look, Irinia, I know it seems like he can't do it. But with us there, with Nona, we can make this work.

MIKEY

Yeah, and if we cancel its like another three months before we can close.

IRINIA

WHAT!

MIKEY

Three months.

IRINIA

Our lease is us in four weeks! We have not place to go.

MIKEY

I'm sure Mika and -

MIKA

No, no, we won't! We won't becaue we can do this. Right. Team work. Make dream work.

IRINIA

Ok, jsut come over and we'll figure it out. MARTIN!

Irinia hangs up. Mikey does an exaggerated exhale.

MIKA

Go to house. Let's get Nona.

MIKEY

I thought she was going to drive.

MIKA

No, no. Too many ... uh variables. Let pick here up. Is on the way.

Mikey says this outloud.

MIKEY
Siri, call Lana.

MIKA
Who is that?

MIKEY
Lana? Lana the attorney.

Phone rings. Mika grabs phone and hangs up.

MIKEY
What are you doing.

MIKA
Why call? What reason?

MIKEY
To let her know the closing might
not go happen.

MIKA
No, no no no no no. No call.
Are you crazy, just tell no one.
Lets get everyone to clerks office
and figure out. You tell this Lana
it might not happen and red flags
everywhere. Have you actually sold
a house?

Mikey motions to the BMW

MIKEY
Hello, yes!

MIKA
You, you should get into politics.
As long as people like, which people
do like you, you can be as stupid as
you want and succeed.

Mikey pulls into Mika's driveway. Nona is waiting.

MIKEY
Oh look, Nona is ready.

MIKA
Yes, genius. I text her. Whatever
you do, whatever, just confidence.
All well. You know, smooth deal.

NONA
Hi Mikey. How are you!

MIKEY

Oh Nona, great! Great! You look fantastic.

NONA

Oh Mikey, I like this car very much.
This is very nice. The back seat
is roomy.

MIKEY

Oh thanks. You know, I thought of
something a while back. If you are
going to drive, you have to do it in
style. We spend so much time in
cars. You know, you spend -

MIKA

Yes, we know, like a 1/3 of you
waking life in a car. Right?

MIKEY

Right! Can't go cheap.

NONA

Oh absolutely Mikey. I see the Land
Rovers - I think I might want one.

MIKEY

Oh, I know the head salesman. I do!
I really do. I helped him get a
condo in Myrtle Beach. I think I
could get it at cost - no commission.

NONA

Possibly, this is something to think
about after the house closes.

MIKA

Great. Excellent. Please
concentrate on driving. That was
not a full stop at the stop sign.

NONA

I want to test drive one first.

MIKEY

Of course, I meant you have to put
yourself behind the wheel before you
do anything. They even let you keep
it overnight. I drove one for six
months and loved it.

MIKA

Wait, why six? Lease at least two
years, why six.

MIKEY

How do you know I didn't buy it?

Mika looks at Mikey and shakes head.

MIKEY

It got toatalled. Not my my fault -

Scene forward to Mikey pulling into driveway. A large dog comes spriting out of the back and barks at a side fence. It is a great dane mix of some sort.

MIKEY

So, like I said - the contrcution work - they guy had never seen concrete barriers in the middle of the freeway. I mean, his car was upside down, his daughter was crying on the side of the road.

NONA

This sounds terrible Mikey! I am glad you are ok.

MIKA

Ho ho, who is that guy?

MIKEY

Oh, thats ... Romulus? I think? They got a dog. Once they got the new house, they got a dog. Resuce dog.

MIKA

Let me understand, new baby in house, and they get a dog?

MIKEY

Yep.

MIKA

Actually, does not Marjean hate dogs.

NONA

Yes, this is good thing.

MIKA

Ok, so, Nona, I mention that Martin have little injury on job. I may have to help him to car. No worries though.

Irinia comes out and sees them. She is in complete tears, though somewhat nicely dressed.

IRINIA

Oh Mikey, Mika. Nona! (Irinia forces a smile)

NONA

Oh baby, do not worry. Tell me what happened. Lets go check on baby.

MIKA

Wait, wait, wait, where is Marting?
Where is her.

IRINIA

Oh in the kids bedroom. Tatums.
Didn't want him and the baby in the
same room.

Mika and Mikey walk down the hallway to Tatum's room.
Before entering he looks to Mikey.

MIKA

Ok, whatever happen, you do what I
say. Do what I say! I fight in
Afghan war and survive. I escape
communist Russia. Listen to me.
Listen!

Mika opens the door. Marin is on bed. Jeans, no shirt,
face down, groaning.

MARTIN

Irinia, Irinia?

MIKA

No, not Irinia.

Martin rolls over.

MARTING

Ohhhh.... Irinia...gatorade please.
My mouth is so dry.

MIKA

You want Gatorade? Ok?

MARTIN

Irinia ohhh ... Gatorade,
please.

MIKEY

I'll get some!

Mika then sees prescription. Clearly oxycodone. Take
twice daily for five days. No refills. He opens the
bottle to find five pills left. He also sees an empty
Miller Lite on the night stand.

MIKA

5 ... 10.. what the fuck.

MARTIN

Irinia ... Gatorade.

Martin walks down the hallway. He has the pills and bottle in his possession. Enters kitchen where Nona and Irinia talk.

NONA

Shhh - baby is sleeping. Angela is so sweet! So sweet!

IRINIA

I know! I know! Susanna was cute but there is something about Angela.

Mika holds up empty bottle.

MIKA

Did he drink this today?

IRINIA

Nah, thats his dip bottle.

MIKA

Dip bottle.

IRINIA

Nevermind. How is he?

MIKA

Oh ... uh ... he is good coming out of it. Hey ... these there were 10 in here yesterday, correct?

IRINIA

Probably, I dunno.

MIKA

Who gives him these?

IRINIA

I did last night. I gave him one last night.

MIKA

But there are many missing.

IRINIA

I dunno, he took it this morning. He said he was in pain, I said take the pills.

MIKA

Ok, just two a day.

IRINIA

I KNOW! Its a controlled substance.
Just two a day. Nona, look these
pictures I took of Angela the other
day. There is one, I swear, she
knows she is getting her picture
taken.

Mika heads back to bedroom. There, Mikey is giving Martin
the Gatorade bottle. Mikey goes to Mika.

MIKEY

Well, what do you think?

MIKA

I think ... I think Martin should go
to have stomach pumped based on
number of pain killers he has taken.
These he CANNOT see. But, he can
make it to the closing.

MARTIN

Irinia ... do we have the Chex? The
Corn Chex.

MIKEY

Oh yeah, I saw those in the kitchen.
Its amazing how many flavors they
have. Do you know in Canada they
dont' get as a big a selection.

MIKA

Look at me. We are closing today.
Will happen. Here is what we do.
One, tell Irinia we drive Martin.
We all drive together. Tell her he
seems ok, seems fine. Say that BMW
has plenty of room. Two, tell
Irinia we will hlep them into the
clerks office. Three, we stay for
closing.

MIKEY

Ok, sounds good. Hey chief, you
read for some Corn Chex. Lets get
you dressed for the big day.

MARTIN

Irinia?

MIKA

You. You sell plan. People trust
you. No clue why. Sell plan.

Mika heads kitchen. Time passes and Mika arrives with
Martin. Martin, amazingly, looks presentable, even his
hair is combed.

MIKEY

This guy is ready, and wants some
Chex.

MARTIN

Corn Chex ... strawberry ones.
Gotta get us a house today.

Irinia enters with the large geat dane.

IRINIA

This is Trooper. He is super
friendly! Won't cause you any
trouble Nona, he'll jsut stand at
the door and lock eyes if he wants
to go out.

Trooper is incredibly friendly and likcs Nona's
outstretched hand.

IRINIA

The food is over here. But he
should be ok, let me feed him.

As Trooper scarfs down his food, Martin scarfs down his
Chex.

MARTIN

Gonna get us a house today baby!

IRINIA

Exactly! Nona, do you know any good
movers? I've alreay started
packing.

NONA

Ok, we can help with the packing and
moving.

MIKA

Yes, we would love to.

Mika looks through the cereals. There is an amazingly
large number of boxes.

IRINIA

Oh, do you want some cereal.

MIKA

Oh no, I have my coffee here. I
just like to see what cereals people
buy. Is fascinating, the diversity.

IRINIA

I'll tell you what, its a lifesaver.
Breakfast, lunch and sometimes
(MORE)

IRINIA (CONT'D)
dinner in a box. Tatum and Kenny
love the stuff. Really, they
probably eat it two nights a week
for dinner.

MIKA
Yes ... is great.

MARTIN
Hey Babe, we're getting a house
today!

MIKA
Yes ... yes we are.

IRINIA
Let me show you a few more things
for Angela before we go.

INT. BMW ON FREEWAY

Irinia is messing with all the controlls and the
interactive panel.

IRINIA
What does this do?

MIKEY
It controls the windows. See you an
do it via the screen or this know
controls evetyhing.

IRINIA
Oh!

MIKEY
Let me show you a trick. Press the
center all the way down and turn
right.

All the windows come down.

IRINIA
Oh that is great!

Mika is blasted with air in the back seat as is Martin.

MIKA
Yes, is great on July day, parking
lot, 95 degree temperatures. Less
good on thruway at 65 miles and
hour. Irinia closes all but Martin
opens his again and sticks hand out
to catch the air.

MARTIN

Birsds. Birds. Air flows over wings, learned in science class.

MIKA

Yes, science.

MARTIN

Ya know, in second grade we learned about the Pilgrims. Thanksgivin. Learned that too ... black close and the hats.

Martin looks out the window and his hand. Mika looks forward.

IRINIA

And I like this cup holder. It pops out of the console!

MIKEY

Oh Irinia, they thought of evething on this car. Everything!

IRINIA

I think I should get a BMW. You leaase, right? I wanted to lease but my mom talked me out of it.

MIKEY

Oh, absolutely, absolutely! You have to lease. Leasing is the way to go. A new car every two years. It's fantastic.

MIKA

Yes, is great idea.

MIKEY

Mika, Mika! You are going to come around and see things my way! Same thing with the timeshares. You can take what you get for this house and instead of one condo, turn it into three timeshares. Go to all these different places! I'm telling you.

MIKA

Yes, yes. Is like card game. Great.

IRINIA

I like card games. Their fun.

MIKA

Well, timeshares are not like playing Go Fish.

Irinia turns to Mika.

IRINIA
I play complicated games than Go
Fish. Thank you.

She then turns back.

MARTIN
I like fish. The sweedish fish are
the best. They have the multicolor
ones ... but those aren't the
Swedish ones.

MIKA
You play complex games. Like what,
solitaire.

IRINIA
Bridge, for one.

MIKA
Bridge? You? You play bridge?

IRINIA
Yes, yes I do, why is that surpring.

MIKA
There is no way, no way you know how
to play bridge.

Irinia gets irritated.

IRINIA
Yes, yes there are ways. I play very
well thank you.

MIKA
Bridge? You? You play bridge?

IRINIA
Yes, yes I do. Why is that
surprising?

MIKA
There is no way. No way you know how
to play bridge.

Irinia gets irritated.

IRINIA
Yes, yes there are ways. I play very
well, thank you.

MIKA
Okay. Then answer this. In bridge
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)
the seated positions are left,
right, across, and self. True or
false?

IRINIA
False. They're North, South, East,
and West.

MIKA
Fine. Dealer is always South.

IRINIA
No. Dealer rotates clockwise after
every hand.

MIKA
Lucky guess. Vulnerability changes
every hand too, right?

IRINIA
Not every hand. It follows a board
pattern. Sometimes nobody is
vulnerable, sometimes both sides
are.

MIKA
Hmm.

He studies her.

MIKA (CONT'D)
What does a takeout double ask your
partner to do?

IRINIA
Bid a suit. Usually their longest
unbid suit. Unless they have some
reason to pass.

MIKA
And if your partner opens one
no-trump, what point range is that?

IRINIA
Depends on the system, but usually
fifteen to seventeen.

MIKA
Interesting.

He leans forward.

MIKA (CONT'D)
What would you open with this hand?
Spades ace-queen-seven-three, hearts
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)
king-nine-four, diamonds
eight-five-two, clubs
queen-ten-six-three.

IRINIA
Pass.

MIKA
Pass?

IRINIA
Eleven high-card points. Balanced
hand. Four spades, not five. Not
enough to open in standard methods.

Mika stares at her.

MIKA (CONT'D)
Who taught you bridge?

IRINIA
My mom. I'm really good. Its fun!

MIKA
No.

IRINIA
What?

MIKA
Nobody answers that hand with "pass"
unless they've actually played. We
will talk about this more later.
Mikey, keep driving.

IRINIA
Uhhhh my boobs hurt. Uhhh!

MIKA
Did you pump? This morning? Did
you pump?

IRINIA
Yes! Don't ever ask that again.
Please.

Martin sleeps with hand out window as they drive on.

INT. OF CLERKS OFFICE

Two woman at a long table. The table is old, hard wood.
The woman are in the early 50s with stacks of stapled,
organized papers in front of them. They are in a bustling
clerks office.

WOMAN 1

Is Hamerlik still with the firm.
Roger?

WOMAN 2

No he left (she looks up and thinks)
four years ago. I thought five but
its definitely four.

WOMAN 1

I like Roger. He was my son's
basketball coach.

WOMAN 2

Absolutely, a great guy. Great guy.
You know he got divorced right?

WOMAN 1

Yes, that was while he was coaching.
One of the other mom's told me. I
think it was the Olsen mother.

WOMAN 2

He me some professor at the
Unviersity and just decided to move
with her. He went somewhere,
Lousiville, Nashville ... Memphis?
Around there.

Woman 1 stands up.

WOMAN 1

Oh yes, a fresh start. Nothing says
opportunity like Memphis. Ok these
... these are good. I just checked
them all. I'm gonna get a cup of
coffee. You want anything?

WOMAN 2

Yeah, get me, uh, get me (she
thinks) Snick- no Muskateer. Get me
a Three Muskateers.

Woman 1 walks to candy counter with many people flowing
through building. Phone rings.

WOMAN 1

Hey, what's up.

VOICE

Hey

WOMAN 1

Hey

VOICE

Uh, um, I went to the Super Mart and ... um ... they didn't have any pizza dough.

WOMAN 1

So, what did you get for dinner instead?

VOICE

Well they didn't have any pizza dough, so that why I am calling.

WOMAN 1

You ... there's pizza dough in the freeze. You can take it out. It should thaw in time.

VOICE

Oh ... ok.

WOMAN 1

And I wanted peppers on it. Do they have red peppers there?

VOICE

I dunno. i'm home.

WOMAN 1

What? Why are you home? Why didn't you call me from the Mart?

VOICE

I dunno ... I just didn't. I didn't see any dough so I came back home and decided to call you.

WOMAN 1

Ok, I get that part. That part I understand. I'm asking why didn't you just call from the store?

VOICE

I said, I dunno. I just didn't see the dough so I decided to come home and call you.

WOMAN 1

Ok. Ok ... so go back and get the peppers. And the cheese. Just get everything for the pizza.

VOICE

Oh, ok.

WOMAN 1

And if you have a question or don't know what to do ... call me from the store. From the store!

VOICE

Well ... the thing is -

WOMAN 1 lowers the phone. She is at the counter and the cashier.

WOMAN 1

Hi Ed, do you have a Three Muskateers? I don't see any. I need one cup of coffee black.

EDWARD

No we are out.

Woman 1 brings the phone back up.

VOICE - And thats why I feel like - you - not equal in this relationship at times.

WOMAN 1

Oh God not this not now. Look - just the stuff for the pizza and we can talk later.

VOICE

But -

WOMAN 1

Bye! Busy!

Woman 1 hangs up.

WOMAN 1

Ok ... what else do we have here.

EDWARD

We have a scone. We have scones.

WOMAN 1

Not even remotely like a three muskateers. But ok. Whats a Zagnut like?

EDWARD

The scones are good too. THEY have chocolate chips in them.

WOMAN 1

Great. I'll take the coffe and the Zagnut.

EDWARD

Do you want the scone - buy one get one -

WOMAN 1

Sure, put one right here Ed. Right here.

Edward, puzzled, places it in a bag in front of her. Woman 1 smashes the bag with her fist but the scone does not break.

WOMAN 1

Ed ... a scone is supposed to be buttery and crumbly and delectable! Not brick like. How long have these been.

EDWARD

A while I guess. No one wants these. This stuff - the vendor - they kept telling me to get them - that they would sell. None, not one. The donuts meanwhile -

WOMAN 1

Ed, one Zagnut, one black coffee. Thanks.

EDWARD

Ok, ok. Zagnuts, good choice.

WOMAN 1

Thanks. Thank you Ed.

Woman 1 heads back to the table. She tosses down the Zagnut. Woman 2 looks stunned.

WOMAN 2

That's not a Three Musketeers.

WOMAN 1

No, it's better. Who is ...

Woman 1's attention is now on the concourse. She sees Mikey smiling and laughing with guards. Irinia is putting jewelry into a bin. Her attention is focused on Mika who is literally helping Martin to the security gate. She hears one of the guards.

GUARD 1

Hey I told you once. Don't do that. This is the second warning. Don't do that!

Woman 1 heads over to the metal detector.

WOMAN 2

This is actually better than a Three Muskateers.

Woman 1 is now at the metal detector.

WOMAN 1

Hi - you're - I am going to guess, Irinia? Are you Irinia.

IRINIA

Yes, yes! You are?

WOMAN 1

Cynthia Wald. We spoke on the phone. I work for Schuyler and Farbman. I - we spoke on the phone about the closing. I'm your lawyer. Its great to meet you. Um ... who are all these people?

IRINIA

Oh, that Mikey - my real eastate agent.

CYNTHIA

I know Mikey, hi.

IRINA

And Martin is there. And thats Mika.

CYNTHIA

Who is Mika?

IRINIA

He is the seller. He's selling the house.

CYNTHIA

He doesn't need to be here. In fact -

GUARD 2

Ok - listen. Hey! If he can't walk through the metal detector - they you can't help him. Unless he has a wheel chair or something. This ain't no friggin marathon.

MIKA

Percoset.

GUARD 1

What?

MIKA

Percoset. See the thumb. He hurt his hand so he is on a pain killer. I must tell you that.

GUARD 2

What?

GUARD 1

He's high? We can't let him.

MIKA

No, no, no. He has to close on a house. He hurt his hand last night. If he does not close today the house goes back on the market. Back on the market!

Cynthia talks to the guards.

CYNTHIA

Guys, they are here for a closing. I am representing ... this. I'll watch him. Any issue, you can toss us all. Nothing will happen.

GUARD 2

So you know them.

CYNTHIA

Yeah, it will be fine.

GUARD 1

Ok. But buddy, you try to use the metal detector as a pull bar again and you are out.

MARTIN

I was not. I don't think.

Martin makes it through and Irinia helps him.

GUARD 2

You. You next. Go.

As Mika goes through an alarm goes off.

GUARD 2

Come back. You gott belt.

MIKA

Why, why? How could this set it off!

GUARD 2

You got something else that would set it off!

GUARD 1

Cynthia, any bullshit from these
guys and they are out. I mean out.
First one is that guy.

Guard points to Mika.

MIKA

I know. I know. You do job. I
understand. No problem, I promise.

Cynthia shepherds the group toward the large room with
many tables.

CYNTHIA

So, maybe someone can explain what
we have an entire entourage for a
closing. We just need Irinia and
... what is his name?

MIKA

Martin. I am Mika.

CYNTHIA

Great, your the seller right.

MIKA

Yes, is correct.

CYNTHIA

We don't need you here! In fact it
would be better if you were not
here!

MIKA

Oh no, no, I must be here. Must see
it close. I know Mikey, Irinia,
want only the best for everyone.

CYNTHIA

Great, its not like we are having a
baby here. We don't need the whole
family.

MARTIN

Baby. I have one. Angela. She's
around here somewhere. Angela?

CYNTHIA

Whats wrong with him. He looks -

MIKA

Like he is on another planet. Yes,
we know.

CYNTHIA

I think we can all see it.

IRINIA

His hand. See, he has two jobs. He does tiles. He has his own company. But on off days or half days he finds work. So, he was doing a closet redo. His asshole friend made him laugh when we using the osciallating and saw and ... well .. you see the thumb.

MARTIN

28 holding it.

MIKA

I did not know a friend caused this?
Who is this guy?

CYNTHIA

28 what?

MIKEY

Stiches. Holding the fingernail on.
The crazy thing ... the stich goes
RIGHT THROUGH the nail!

Cynthia holds up her hands in a stop motion.

CYNTHIA

I don't need hear another thing.
Not one more thing. You have about
15 minutes before a table opens up
You will be next.

MIKA

Great!

CYTHIA

But you have to sit here. And not
cause any trouble. None! Is he
going to be able sig his name?

MIKA

Yes, he can do it.

CYTHIA

Great. He just needs to be able to
sign his name. Two things. Three
things. Have a pulse, be able to
sign name, and not be raving
lunatic.

MIKEY

Good on all points. No issues.

She points to a bench. All sit. The woman heads back to her table.

WOMAN 1
Who are they.

CYNTHIA
Its Mika, Martin, Irinia, and Mikey.

WOMAN 1
Who?

CYNTHIA
Exactly.

INT. RANGE ROVER

We see Mika and Irinia. It is early evening and they are riding.

MIKA
Nona, of course, wants to know how
is Angela. I do to, of course.

IRINIA
She is great! The new room is
working out really well.

MIKA
Is it like vision board. Nona says
it is.

IRINIA
Perfect. Just like the board.
Martin was off work so ... he was
still able to paint it and add the
trim.

MIKA
That is just great! Great.

IRINIA
Oh, Martin wants to know if there
are any shingles.

MIKA
Yes, why.

IRINIA
One of them blew off. He needs to
repalce it.

MIKA
A roof shingle is not light! This
thing did not fly far. He should
find it easily.

IRINIA
Tatum found it first.

MIKA

Enough said. Is in garage.

IRINIA

Where?

MIKA

In the rafters.

The car parks and both exit. They head into a community center type building.

MIKA

Now remember, no nonsense. Play risky but controlled.

IRINIA

I know. I know! We beat Earl and Harrison all the time.

MIKA

Yeah, they are not best players. Look, I could teach someone off street the rules of bridge for one hour and be able to beat them. Besides they are more interested in the baby when you come to play.

IRINIA

Oh, tell Samantha I said hi the next time you are there! She has an appointment with me next week.

MIKA

Great, great. Very happy. But now is time to focus.

They approach a check-in table with a sign giving the rules of the bridge tournament.

IRINIA

Hmmm ... we're going to win \$800 dollars.

TABLE MINDER

Well thats if you win. Names please.

MIKA

It is Mika and Irinia, right there.

TABLE MINDER

Ok Mika and Irene -

IRINIA

Irinia - not Irene - Irinia.

TABLE MINDER

I-ree-ny-ah ok. Here is your draw.
You start at table 8.

They hear a voice from behind. As they turn we see the old woman from the library. She holds a cup of coffee.

OLD WOMAN

Oh, Mika and Irinia. So nice. The Soviet Bloc is here. Good luck!

As she walks away, a fired up Irinia.

IRINIA

Who the fuck was that! (to the table minder) Hey you, When do we play them.

MIKA

Exactly!